

INBRIEF



Gupta launches 'Udyog Mitra' portal for traders, investors

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday launched the 'Delhi Udyog Mitra' portal, a digital platform aimed at strengthening the ease of doing business ecosystem in the city by providing easier access to government services and approvals through a single digital interface, the CMO stated in an official release. The portal integrates more than 50 government services from 15 departments. The initiative is expected to make access to government services easier and more convenient for entrepreneurs, start-ups, industrial units and investors, including over eight lakh traders in the city, the CMO stated.

Week after Kalkaji gang rape, DU students march for safety

At least 3,000 women students from Delhi University marched through the North Campus demanding safer public and institutional spaces on Monday afternoon, a week after the alleged gang rape of a 17-year-old girl in Kalkaji. Students of Miranda House marched to the Faculty of Arts, where students of other colleges joined them. They sought functioning Internal Complaints Committees, better street lighting, improved public transport and greater accountability in handling sexual harassment complaints. They spoke against survivor-blaming, moral policing, surveillance-driven safety measures, and proposals to restrict women's access to public spaces after dark.

Non-cognizable report filed against Parvesh; AAP MLA faces FIR

Report filed a day after Minister slapped 22-year-old man in Tilak Nagar; how can PM hope to connect with Gen Z if Ministers slap youth: Kejriwal

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Delhi Police on Monday registered a non-cognizable report against Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh for slapping a 22-year-old man during a road inspection in Tilak Nagar on Sunday.

The report – a police diary entry for a minor offence, where no FIR is registered and no arrest can be made without a Magistrate's order – was filed for voluntarily causing hurt based on a complaint by Sahib Singh, an aide to Aam Aadmi Party's (AAP) local MLA Jarnail Singh, who said he was recording a video when the Minister slapped him.

The police have also registered an FIR against the Tilak Nagar MLA for "obstructing" public servants in the discharge of their duty, an officer said.

Meanwhile, Opposition parties upped the ante against the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) over the attack on the youth.

AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal dared Prime Minister



AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal addressing mediapersons with MP Sanjay Singh (left) and Tilak Nagar MLA Jarnail Singh (right) on Monday. PTI

Narendra Modi to get Mr. Parvesh arrested to "win the hearts of Gen Z", saying, "If a BJP Minister publicly slaps a youngster, how will Gen Z connect with the Prime Minister?"

'Arrogance of power'
Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge denounced what he described as the "arrogance of power". "Delhi's Ministers are slapping youth. Under [Union Home Minister] Amit Shah's watch, youth were baton-charged at Jantar Mantar," he said.

Earlier in the day, the AAP chief visited the spot where Mr. Jarnail had peeled off portions of the road surface by hand in Mr. Parvesh's presence. He alleged corruption in the

construction of roads and sought action against those responsible. "Then, Modi ji, you won't need to make reels at midnight, nor will you need to go bhajjan clubbing and Gen Z across the country will connect with you," he said. AAP later held a protest seeking an FIR against Mr. Parvesh.

The Minister hit back, saying the country had witnessed how "young girls are being beaten" by Punjab Police, referring to the agitation on the campus of Lovely Professional University over the alleged rape of a student. "Kejriwalji, you also have a daughter, and you have not said a single word about it, neither has the Punjab CM [Bhagwant Mann]," he said.

(With inputs from PTI)

Rahul Gandhi visits JJ cluster in Bela Estate, questions deletion of voters' names from SIR draft roll

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Monday visited a *jhuggi-jhopri* (JJ) cluster on the Yamuna floodplains in the Bela Estate polling area, where the names of 728 of the 729 voters were left out of the draft electoral roll under the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) exercise in Delhi.

Mr. Gandhi said the exclusion of voters' names was "unjustified".

The issue centres on residents who continued to live at the same address in makeshift shelters after their houses were demolished by the Delhi Development Authority in 2023.

The residents said they had submitted their enumeration forms during the revision, but of the 729 voters on the pre-SIR electoral roll for the area, the names of 728 were still placed in the absent, shifted, dead or duplicate (ASDD) voters list. According to Kamal Lal, a resident, about 550 of them continue to live in the cluster and 496 have since submitted Form 6 applications seeking inclusion in the final roll as new voters.

"Today, I went to their *jhuggi* and heard directly from them what the Elec-



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi speaking to residents of the JJ cluster on the Yamuna floodplains on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

tion Commission has done to them," Mr. Gandhi wrote in a post on X after meeting the residents.

'No connection to votes'
The senior Congress leader said the demolition of their houses should not determine their right to vote. "Having a house or not has no connection to the right to vote. These people have been living here for decades. They have already voted in the 2024 Lok Sabha election and the 2025 Delhi election," he added.

Mr. Gandhi claimed Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar had earlier stated that enumerators could enter "house number 0" in the forms of homeless voters.

Mr. Lal said the Congress leader asked the residents to meet him at his office on Tuesday. "He will

raise our issue of rehabilitation," he said.

Mr. Gandhi said he had spoken to the area Sub-Divisional Magistrate about the issue.

'Visit not needed'
Meanwhile, Delhi Chief Electoral Officer Ashok Kumar's office stated in a release that electors who have received notices over "no mapping" or "logical discrepancies" will not have to visit the assigned centres to submit documents. Booth Level Officers will instead visit their houses to collect the required documents, the statement added.

"The documents will subsequently be uploaded on the ECINet platform for the Electoral Registration Officer to take a decision on their eligibility," read the statement.

Sharjeel seeks access to data to finish PhD; HC asks jail officials to respond

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Monday asked Tihar Jail authorities to respond to a plea by student activist Sharjeel Imam seeking access to research material stored on a pen drive to complete his PhD.

His counsel said Mr. Imam was in the final year

of his PhD at the time of his arrest. His synopsis has been approved by the University Grants Commission and Jawaharlal Nehru University, his counsel added. Mr. Imam was arrested on August 25, 2020 and booked under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act for being one of the 'masterminds' of the February 2020 riots in north-

east Delhi that left 53 people dead.

Justice Sanjeev Narula issued notices to the jail authorities and directed them to file a report while scheduling the next hearing for November 2.

Mr. Imam has sought access to the pen drive using a stand-alone computer inside the prison without internet connectivity.

'Not even one day off': teachers juggle BLO, exam duties

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Between 10 a.m. and noon on September 22, Nitika's phone kept buzzing with calls from unknown numbers, none of which she could take. She was invigilating an examination at the school where she teaches in Mustafabad. By the next day, complaints had reached the local election office that their Booth

Level Officer (BLO), Ms. Nitika, was not responding to voters seeking help with their special intensive revision (SIR) proceedings.

Assigned as a BLO in July last year, Ms. Nitika said she has barely taken a day off since December, juggling teaching with SIR-related work.

"The pressure is immense. It all started with the pre-SIR work. Now we have to conduct hearings

as well. Nobody asks us before adding extra work," the 30-year-old said.

Delhi has 14,947 polling booths and as many BLOs. Their responsibilities during the SIR have extended from the six-month pre-SIR mapping and enumeration phase to serving notices to 33.1 lakh electors, collecting and uploading documents, and handling the claims and objections phase, voter enrolment

camps and verification.

The workload has taken a toll on BLOs, many of whom are teachers. Rishabh*, a BLO from Timarpur, has delivered about 40% of the 275 notices assigned to him while also teaching Class 11 students. "Who will be responsible for students who have board exams?" he said.

In north-east Delhi, Priyanshu* said he had spent the past 10 days delivering

notices until 11 p.m. "Our problem is that we cannot take even one day off. Why? In fact, there are special camps on Sundays," he said. The BLOs said they had not received payments for their work for a year.

Mr. Priyanshu said when they sought overtime payments, they were told they were already being paid ₹33 a day.

(*Names changed on request)

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IN THE COURT OF THE
JUDGE OF SMALL CAUSES
AND MOTOR ACCIDENT
CLAIMS TRIBUNAL
AT MYSURU
M.V.C. No. 2473/2025

PETITIONER : Reethesh. I. M
V/s

RESPONDENTS: Proprietor,
Bombay Punjab Goods
Carriers & another

SUMMONS UNDER ORDER
V RULE 20 AGAINST THE
RESPONDENT NO: 1

1. Proprietor, Bombay Punjab Goods Carrier, No. AG-407, Sanjay Gandhi Transport Nagar, North-West, Delhi - 110042 Whereas the above named Petitioner has filed the above Petition for the relief of compensation by motor vehicle accident against you / your vehicle. You are hereby notified to appear before the Judges of Principal Small Causes and Motor Accident Claims Tribunal at Mysuru either in person or through a duly authorized advocate/pleader on the 02 day of November 2026 at 11:00 A.M. to answer the claims of the Petitioner and in default of your appearance on the said date and time the matter will be heard and decided ex-parte in your absence.

Given under my hand and the seal of the court this 26-09-2026. By order of the Court
Sd/- Chief Administrative Officer
Court of Judge Small Causes and Motor at Mysuru
Advocate for the Petitioners
Sd/- Sri. Sandeep Raj K
#1346, CH-10, 1st Link Road, 4th West Cross, Krishnamurthy puram, Mysuru

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, VIRENDRA Prasad s/o Ghana Nand r/o Block J H.No -2A, Street No 6, Laxmi Nagar Delhi -92 born on 16th January, 1973 have changed my name to Virendra Raturi vide affidavit dated 26/09/2026 at Delhi for all the purposes.

LEGAL NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE
BEFORE THE SOLE ARBITRATOR
HON'BLE SH. MANISH KUMAR,
(UNDER AGIS OF DIAC)
IN THE MATTER OF ARBITRATION
BETWEEN
Mr. Ashutosh Singh Gautam
.....CLAIMANT
Versus
M/S FITJEE Ltd.
.....RESPONDENT

TO,
M/S FITJEE LTD. Regd. Add: 29 A, Kalu Sarai, Sarapuriya Vihar, South Delhi, New Delhi, Delhi 110016. Email: cs@fitjee.com
TAKE NOTICE that an arbitration proceeding has been initiated against you by the Claimant above-named, arising out of the disputes and differences under the Service Contract for Employees, executed dated: 10.06.2023.
WHEREAS, the LD. Arbitral Tribunal consisting of Sole Arbitrator Hon'ble Sh. Manish Kumar was constituted to adjudicate the disputes between the parties.
WHEREAS, attempts to serve you with the Notice of Arbitration/Statement of Claim at your registered Email Id and at registered address via speed post has been satisfied, and despite complete service since none has appeared on your behalf, the Arbitral Tribunal has, vide its order dated: 21.09.2026, directed the service of notice upon you by way of Newspaper Publication.
YOU ARE HEREBY REQUIRED to take note of the upcoming arbitration proceedings scheduled to be held on:
• Date: 08.10.2026
• Time: 02.00 pm to 03.00 pm
• Venue/Mode: DIAC, Delhi High Court Campus/Physical Hearing
You are further required to appear before the Arbitral Tribunal either in person or through an authorized legal representative on the aforementioned date and time.
Given under my hand/issued under instructions this 28th day of September, 2026.

FOR AND ON BEHALF OF THE CLAIMANT,
ARHAY AJAY GAUTAM, ADVOCATE
Counsel for the Claimant
17/1, LGF, Kalkaji Vihar Delhi - 110019
info@anbaylegal.com
+91-9999294583

IN THE COURT OF THE
1ST ADDITIONAL DISTRICT
JUDGE TIRUNELVELI
MACOP. No. 480/2026
Murugan & Others
Vs
P. Raj, S/o. Ponnah,
No.F-228, Lado Sarai,
New Delhi - 110030.
... 1st Respondent.
NOTICE

Please take notice that the petitioners in the above case has filed claim application on account of death of their mother in a vehicular accident held on 18.12.2025 at Tirunelveli - Tuticorin Road, near Esakkiamman Temple. The above case is posted on 29-10-2026 for appearance of the 1st respondent before this Hon'ble Court on 10.00 A.M, failing which the court will decide the 1st respondent as 'Called Ex-parte' in this case.
-As per Court Order -
By Advocate
A.SELVARAJ, B.Sc., B.L.,
Tuticorin. ☎ 99940 21194

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of Axis Bank Ltd. that Borrower i.e. M/s Sakarni Plaster India Pvt. Ltd. intends to mortgage the Plot bearing Nos. G1-356, and G1-357, having area measuring 3997.50 Sq. Mtrs., Plot No. G1-357(A) area measuring 10000 Sq. Mtrs., & Plot No. G-359(A) area measuring 1738 Sq. Mtrs., Situated in the Industrial area Growth Centre Khara, Tehsil Khara, District Bikaner, Rajasthan with our client Axis Bank Ltd against the financial assistance. Whereas, M/s Sakarni Plaster (India) Pvt. Ltd. acquired the said property vide Sale Deed dt. 18.08.2022. However, out of the chain link documents, 1. Lease Agreement dt. 18.11.2011 executed by RIICO in favour of Mrs. Sushila Kanwar prop of M/s Sushila Kanwar in respect of the said property, 2. Original Office Order dt. 19.02.2016 issued by RIICO in favour of M/s Pandhi Udyog through its partners Mr. Amit Gupta, Mr. Saurabh Garg, and Mr. Jagjiwan Goyal with regard to merger of Plot bearing Nos. G1-356, and G1-357, having area measuring 3997.50 Sq. Mtrs., Plot No. G1-357(A) area measuring 10000 Sq. Mtrs., & Plot No. G-359(A) area measuring 1738 Sq. Mtrs., total area measuring 15735.50 Sq. Mtrs., Situated in the Industrial area Growth Centre Khara, Tehsil Khara, District Bikaner, Rajasthan were lost/misplaced somewhere between Bikaner and delhi and in this regard FIR/LR Nos. 620439/2026 dt. 10.09.2026 were lodged.

Public is hereby informed not to deal with the above mentioned documents & the property. If anyone do the same, then he will be responsible for all consequences. If any person(s) having objection with regard to mortgage of the said property, he is advised to intimate in writing to undersigned within 15 days from the date of issue of this notice at below address. In the event no information is received within 15 days from date hereof, our Client i.e. Axis Bank Ltd. will proceed with the mortgage process.

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'CRITICAL THINKING UN-CONFERENCE' HELD

Bhavan Vidyalaya, Panchkula, as part of Panchkula Sahodaya and in collaboration with Thinking Classroom, hosted The Critical Thinking Un-Conference, drawing over 90 principals and school leaders from across North India. Principal Mrs. Gulshan Kaur delivered the welcome address, and Mr. Aneesh Bangia, Co-founder of Thinking Classroom, outlined the vision behind the model. Sessions were led by Mr. Abhishek Kariwal, Co-Founder, Thinking Classroom; Prof. Lakshmana Rao Pinninti, IIT Kanpur; Prof. Jaison A. Manjaly, IIT Gandhinagar; and Prof. Kritika Bhattacharjee, Ashoka University, exploring critical thinking as essential to meaningful learning. The programme concluded with certificate distribution.

'NEEV' SACRED FOUNDATION LAUNCHED

Delhi Scholars International School, Sector-88, Greater Faridabad, under the guidance of Chairman Sh. T. S. Dalal and Director Mr. Prayas Dalal, organised 'NEEV - The Sacred Foundation' for children aged 2-5 years and their parents, drawing participation from 10 play schools. Principal Ms. Kumud Kapoor delivered the welcome address, presenting the school's vision for holistic child development. Children explored activity zones including Math Mania, Science Experiments and Sensory Play. Ms. Alka Chaudhary, Head Dietitian, and Ms. Simran Malik, Clinical Psychologist, offered guidance on nutrition and emotional well-being, followed by a parent session and School Choir performance.

'CIRCUS' CLASS PRESENTATION

Gurukul The School's young Gurukulites of Grade I and II presented "Circus," weaving laughter, wonder, strength and compassion, exploring the making of a balanced, confident personality through five dimensions of growing up—Fun, Strength, Compassion, Amazement and Magic. Esteemed guests Sh. Manoj Srivastava, Director (Training), CBSE; Sh. Vikas Kashyap, ADM; Ms Prachi Shandilya, President, UP Police Welfare Association; Ms Deeksha Gupta; and Ms Priyashree Pal, ACP, graced the event and congratulated the School Leadership—Mr. Sachin Vats, Founder Director; Ms Shikha Vats, Director Administration; Mr Divakar Tewari, Director Finance; and Mr. Gaurav Bedi, Principal—for the meaningful presentation.

For Subscription related queries, please contact Kapil Nagar:
Handphone: +91 9810089457/Email: kapil.nagar@thehindu.co.in

AISA delegation submits intimation letter for Oct. 2 stir; police yet to give nod

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Three days after the Delhi police detained protesters attempting to reach Jantar Mantar, a delegation of the All India Students' Association (AISA), led by its president Neha Bora, on Monday submitted an "intimation letter" at the Parliament Street police station regarding a proposed protest on October 2 demanding the resignation and arrest of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the ongoing special intensive revision exercise.

The delegation included activist Yogendra Yadav, senior advocate Prashant Bhushan, Rashtriya Janata Dal MP Manoj Jha, social activist Nikhil Dey, and academic Nandita Narain.

"The right of citizens to peacefully assemble and express their views is an important constitutional freedom," the letter stated, adding, "It is in exercise of this fundamental right that we are intimating you."

The Delhi police acknowledged receipt of the letter but clarified that this did not amount to permission for the protest. A stamp on the letter read, "This is not a permission. It is only an acknowledgement of your letter."

The organisers, however, said the protest would go ahead at 11 a.m. on October 2.

"It is up to the Delhi police to facilitate us or to face us," Ms. Bora said after submitting the letter.

AISA called upon "all friends of the democratic movement and concerned citizens" to join the protest and asked the police to take necessary steps to facilitate the "peaceful and lawful exercise of our democratic and constitutional rights without unnecessary obstruction or hindrance".

Bombay HC to hear plea on transparency in State SIR

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Bombay High Court on Monday agreed to hear a petition regarding the implementation of the special intensive revision (SIR) in Maharashtra. A Bench posted the matter for hearing on October 5. The petitioners submitted that the matter raised an issue concerning citizens’ rights. Their counsel told the Bench that the exercise could result in the deletion of 2.1 crore names from the electoral rolls in the State.

Timings			
DELHI			
TUESDAY, SEP. 29			
RISE	06:13	SET	18:10
RISE	19:40	SET	08:44
WEDNESDAY, SEP. 30			
RISE	06:13	SET	18:08
RISE	20:26	SET	09:53
THURSDAY, OCT. 01			
RISE	06:14	SET	18:07
RISE	21:20	SET	11:02

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	29	23
Safdarjang	29	23
Palam	28	20

Delhi Palam Today
30°C Morning will be pleasant. The weather will be slight warm. Chances of light rain and thundershower with gusty winds at few places.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
33°C Rise in temperature. The weather will be dry. Day will be warm. Night will be pleasant.

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THE HINDU
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Don’t allow mines Act to be implemented, says Naveen as he calls for united fight

BJD chief and former CM says he would fight for Odisha’s rights till his last breath; party leaders call for halting mineral transportation from mines till MMDR Amendment Act is rolled back

The Hindu Bureau
BHUBANESWAR

Biju Janata Dal (BJD) president and former Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik on Monday appealed to the members of his party and other political parties not to allow the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2026, or MMDR Act to be implemented in Odisha. Leading a demonstration in front of the State Assembly, Mr. Patnaik launched an attack on the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) governments at the Centre and in the State for their alleged “indifferent” mindset to understand the gravity of financial implication of the Act for the State. “This MMDR Amendment Bill is not an ordinary



Naveen Patnaik criticised the BJP governments at the Centre and in Odisha for their ‘indifferent’ mindset. ANI

Bill. It concerns the rights of the State. The people of Odisha are the rightful owners of Odisha’s mines and land. It is unfortunate that such an important Bill was passed in Parliament without any discussion. And why did our 20 BJP MPs remain silent? In whose interest?” he said. “The State government also remained silent. Why? Out of fear of whom? I wrote to the Chief Minister seeking a special session of

the Assembly and urging him to bring a resolution opposing the Act, but there was no response,” Mr. Patnaik said. “Because of this Act, Odisha will suffer losses amounting to thousands of crores of rupees every year,” he said. “I will fight for Odisha’s rights till my last breath. I appeal to all political parties to join in this struggle. Let us come together and make a resolve that we will

not allow the Act to be implemented in Odisha,” he said. Sujata Rout, former IAS officer inducted recently into BJD and wife of V.K. Pandian, close aide of Mr. Patnaik, said, “The revenue generated from the mineral sector could have funded irrigation, education, farmer welfare and infrastructure projects. We could have progressed Odisha by 10 years.”

“The Act proved that the remote control of the State BJP lies with their Central leadership,” she said. The BJD leaders have announced to expand the opposition to the MMDR Act and stop the transportation of minerals from mines. INDIA bloc leaders have called for another demonstration in Bhubaneswar on September 29.

CAG report flags irregularities in use of DMF funds in Odisha

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India has unearthed irregularities in the utilisation of District Mineral Foundation (DMF) funds meant to benefit people and areas affected by mining operations, flagging funds being spent without adherence to rules and ineligible utilisation. The CAG report on performance audit of ‘Implementation of Pradhan Mantri Khanij Kshetra Kalyan Yojana, including the functioning of District Mineral Foundations in Odisha for the year ended March 2024’ said the identification of people directly and indi-

rectly affected by mining was delayed by mineral-bearing districts. As per rule 10(D) of the Odisha DMF Rules, 2015, not more than 40% of the funds may be utilised for taking up activities in the indirectly affected areas.

‘New category’

The report stated that from DMF funds for Keonjhar and Sundargarh, although the utilised amounts were below the threshold limit of 40% for indirectly affected areas, 30.67% and 22.67% of the sanctioned amounts respectively were shown to have been spent under a new category called “common affected areas”. “Amount utilised for indirectly affected areas has in-

creased beyond the stipulated limit to 45.68% in DMF, Keonjhar and 41.10% in DMF, Sundargarh,” the CAG said. Similarly, 19.86% from Jajpur’s DMF funds was spent under “common affected areas”. “This indicated that the creation of the new category was only to accommodate ineligible utilisation within the prescribed limits,” the report said. The CAG also found that while DMF funds amounting to ₹4,541.66 crore were sanctioned for 1,114 projects in “common affected areas” in case of three DMFs (Jajpur, Keonjhar and Sundargarh), ₹2,578.73 crore was utilised without any provision in the rules.

Kerala HC pulls up AMMA

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Kerala High Court has expressed criticism over the high number of petitions arising from disputes between members of the Association of Malayalam Movie Artistes (AMMA). The court made the observation while considering a petition to quash the FIR lodged against actor Lakshmi Priya and others based on a complaint filed by fellow actor Ansiba Hassan. Justice Jobin Sebastian sought the State’s response to a petition filed by Ms. Lakshmi Priya, her husband, P. Jayesh, and Thripunithura Vanitha Cell Sub-Inspector Reshma. “Will we need special courts to hear cases arising from disputes within AMMA?” the court said.

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INBRIEF



Keralam launches second phase of anti-drug drive

Launching the second phase of its anti-drug campaign Operation Toofan, Keralam Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala on Monday said that the incidents of narcotic abuse and peddling have come down by 30 per cent in the State after the first phase in June this year. He called for collective action to keep the drug mafia away from society. Under the second phase, the police will coordinate with local bodies in anti-narcotics enforcement, awareness, and rehabilitation activities. Mr. Chennithala said the campaign has become a major success with the support of mothers and women across the State.

SC to take up acquittal of 22 Sohrabuddin case accused

The Supreme Court on Monday agreed to examine a plea against the Bombay High Court order that upheld the acquittal of all 22 accused in the alleged fake encounter killings of gangster Sohrabuddin Shaikh, his wife Kausar Bi and aide Tulsiram Prajapati in 2005, while voicing concern that 92 witnesses had turned hostile. A Bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana issued notice on the plea filed by Nayabuddin Shaikh, brother of Sohrabuddin Shaikh, challenging the May 7 judgment of the High Court that acquitted 21 police personnel from Rajasthan and Gujarat and a farmhouse owner. PTI

Punjab campus violence triggers political slugfest; varsity blames outsiders

BJP, Congress, Akali leaders demand a probe into LPU incident; university administration alleges outsiders entered campus unlawfully with the intent of disturbing peace; row over video release

Vikas Vasudeva
CHANDIGARH

A day after intense protests and violent clashes between students and police at Lovely Professional University's (LPU) Phagwara campus over the alleged rape of a female student, Opposition parties in Punjab attacked the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government over the State's "deteriorating" law and order situation and demanded a thorough probe into the matter.

On Sunday, protesters blocked NH-44 near Phagwara, vandalised university property, and clashed with the police. The students have alleged that a female hostelier had been raped by a plumber last week. However, LPU has denied the allegations. The police registered an FIR containing rape charges against unknown persons and a special investigation team has been constituted to probe the matter. The alleged victim is yet to be identified.

Director General of Pol-



Police personnel stand guard at the LPU campus in Phagwara as students depart for their home towns on Monday. PTI

ice Gaurav Yadav visited the university on Monday and asserted that those involved in the vandalism would face action, adding that the police had exercised restraint.

'Political resentment'

Rajya Sabha MP Ashok Mittal, who joined the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) after quitting AAP in April this year, is the founder-chancellor of LPU.

Former BJP Punjab president Sunil Jakhar alleged that whenever someone leaves AAP due to its misguided policies, the party uses vengeful actions to ex-

pawns for revenge". Mr. Majhiha and Punjab Congress president Amarinder Singh Raja Warring also demanded a probe in the matter.

'Campus safe'

Even as several students left the campus after the classes were suspended for 10 days and midterm examinations were postponed, the authorities on Monday said the campus was safe.

In a statement, vice chancellor Jaspal Singh said the students' representatives were unanimous that the unrest was primarily the result of outsiders entering the campus unlawfully with the intent of disturbing peace.

Meanwhile, the university, in a bid to pacify the protesters, had released a video of three female students allegedly dismissing claims of a student's rape. On Monday, the three students said the institution had not taken their consent before posting the video and that they were facing abuse and harassment.

HC questions EC over allotment of 'envelope' symbol

Press Trust of India
KOLKATA



The authorities should be fair before the court, said Justice Krishna Rao. FILE PHOTO

The Calcutta High Court on Monday questioned whether there was any "connivance" between the Election Commission and a newly formed political outfit over the reassignment of the 'envelope' symbol, and observed that authorities should be "fair" before the court.

During a hearing on the Indian Secular Front's (ISF) challenge to the EC's decision to allot the symbol to the Democratic Trinamool Congress (DTC), Justice Krishna Rao asked why the poll panel did not consider allotting it to the ISF with which it contested the 2026 Bengal polls.

The EC's counsel submitted that allotment of symbols was within the commission's discretion.

Petitioner's counsel Bikash Ranjan Bhattacharya argued that discretion must be exercised reasonably and "cannot be absolute like an autocrat".

Justice Rao said the conduct of advocates appearing for the parties appeared to reveal "what the connivance is" between them. "If the EC has been guided by the private respondent, what remains further?" the court asked. "The authorities should be fair before the court," Justice Rao observed.

Justice Rao asked how far the court could interfere when the election process was already under way, with nomination, scrutiny and withdrawal of candidature for the October 6 bypolls completed. Mr. Bhattacharya submitted that the Supreme Court had clarified in a judgment that the court had the authority to facilitate the proper conduct of elections. He sought deferment of the bypoll in the interest of justice, saying it would not affect the constitution of the Assembly or create any constitutional crisis.

After hearing both sides, the court reserved its order.

IIT-B student suicide case: parents stage hunger strike, demand professor's arrest

Yohaán Varghese
MUMBAI



Sahil Wakode's parents on hunger strike in Mumbai on Monday. EMMANUAL YOGINI

The parents of IIT Bombay student Sahil Wakode, who died by suicide earlier this month, staged a hunger strike at Azad Maidan in Mumbai on Monday demanding the arrest of Professor Suryanarayana Doolla, who has been named in the FIR registered in connection with their son's death.

Ravindra and Sonali Wakode began their protest at 10 a.m. and continued until around 6.30 p.m. They have now sought permission from the Azad Maidan police to resume their agitation from 9 a.m. on Tuesday. In a handwritten application submitted to the senior police inspector of the police station, advocate Nikhil Kamble, representing the family, sought permission for Mr. Ravindra Wakode to continue the

protest on September 29 demanding justice for Sahil and Prof. Doolla's arrest.

The family also questioned IIT Bombay's internal inquiry into Sahil's death, alleging that none of the members of the institute-appointed committee has contacted them so far. IIT Bombay constituted a 10-member committee to investigate the circumstances surrounding Sahil's death. The panel,

which was initially given a week to complete its inquiry, has since been granted a one-week extension.

The case

Sahil, a second-year B.Tech student, died by suicide in his hostel room on September 18, hours after he sat for a mid-semester examination. Prof. Doolla was investigating the examination.

Following Sahil's death, his parents alleged that he had faced caste-based discrimination and harassment at the institute. Police registered an FIR against the professor; the allegations are under investigation.

Meanwhile, IIT Bombay has relieved Prof. Doolla of his administrative responsibilities and sent him on leave pending the inquiries.

(Those in distress can contact Tele MANAS at 14416 to seek help)

Another POCSO case filed against granite baron Veeramani

S. Vijay Kumar
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai police registered a fresh case against 'Gem Granites' R. Veeramani under the POCSO Act, police sources said on Monday.

The second case was registered on a complaint filed by a woman that her daughter, a minor, was sexually abused by the businessman. The Special Investigation Team (SIT) has taken up the probe in the case. The police booked Veeramani, 85, under the POCSO Act, and are likely to formally arrest him. Veeramani is currently lodged at the Puzhal prison in connection with a different POCSO case.

The police are investigating the statements given by three other women that they were subjected to sexual abuse by him in the past, sources said.

Veeramani is currently lodged at the Puzhal prison in connection with a different POCSO case

Investigators were also probing a complaint from a woman that her daughter, who was abused by Veeramani, had ended her life. The incident occurred years ago. The complainant said that though she had lodged a complaint with the police then, no action was taken, sources said. The police said those willing to file complaints relating to the above cases or share any information could call or send details on WhatsApp to 9345319676. The identity of the sender would be kept confidential.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on Tele-MANAS 14416)

Pawar rules out merger with NCP, says won't join anyone

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI



Nationalist Congress Party (SP) chief Sharad Pawar. FILE

Nationalist Congress Party (SP) chief Sharad Pawar on Monday put a full stop to speculations of a merger with the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) while addressing party workers at the Y.B. Chavan auditorium in Mumbai.

"There are talks about us. As party president, let me tell you, we are not going to join anyone. If anyone wants to come, they can join us. We will strengthen our party," he said, drawing a huge applause from party workers.

NCP leader Ajit Pawar, Mr. Sharad's nephew who died in a plane crash in January this year, had joined hands with the BJP-led National Democratic Alliance (NDA) in 2023, leading to a vertical split in the party.

The NCP is now part of the ruling Mahayuti alliance and led by Maharashtra Deputy Chief Mi-

nister Sunetra Pawar, who is Ajit's wife. The NCP (SP) is part of the Maha Vikas Aghadi, the Opposition alliance in the State that also comprises the Uddhav Thackeray-led Shiv Sena (UBT) and the Congress.

Speculation about whether the NCP (SP) would support the NDA had intensified after Mr. Sharad recently met Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

After seeing the cheer among the cadre, NCP (SP) leader Supriya Sule said it was one of the most invigo-

rating party meetings in the last two and a half years.

"People keep speculating that our party is in trouble. But after looking at you all today, I feel that it is not our party, but our opposition that is in trouble. Our party is in a mood to fight," she said.

'No confusion'

Commenting on Mr. Sharad's statement, NCP (SP) leader Jitendra Awhad said, "There is no confusion. Sharad Pawar has spoken clearly and unambiguously. Doors are not shut for anyone, but we will not join anyone."

During the NCP (SP) meeting, the party leadership also discussed the drought issue in the State, resolving to intensify its agitation on the streets to help secure aid for farmers. Mr. Sharad had earlier demanded that drought be declared in the entire State and not just in 265 talukas.

Bar and Bench: few judicial officers make it to High Courts despite years of experience

Soibam Rocky Singh
NEW DELHI

The elevation of seven district judges to the Delhi High Court recently has once again drawn attention to the narrow path from the subordinate judiciary to the higher Bench, where judicial officers account for only a fraction of the judges despite spending decades deciding cases at the trial-court level.

With Chief Justice D.K. Upadhyaya having administered the oath of office to the new judges, the Delhi High Court's working strength has risen to 50 against a sanctioned strength of 60, of which 19 judges have been drawn from the subordinate courts.

While Article 217 of the Constitution provides two distinct streams for High

Court appointments – members of the Bar and judicial officers – it prescribes no fixed numerical ratio between them. However, a conventional norm has been that two-thirds of vacancies are drawn from the Bar while only one-third are from the judicial service cadre.

The origins of this skewed ratio go back to British rule, said Justice (ret.) R.K. Gauba, who rose from the subordinate cadre to serve on the Delhi High Court Bench.

"Under colonial rule, magisterial courts were predominantly manned by Indian Civil Service officers, focused heavily on *faujdari* (criminal) administration. They were not interested in *deewani* (civil) courts. The Constitution mandated a clear separation of the executive from

the judiciary, which led to the creation of independent State Judicial Services," he told *The Hindu*.

"As the grassroots judiciary developed, logic dictated providing a structured career path. With two constitutional sources, the cake ought to have been divided equally if not more for the judicial services given their vast Bench experience," he added.

Career bottlenecks

Most law graduates join the judicial service as civil judges in their late twenties. From there, it's a slow climb. It usually takes about 10 years to become a senior civil judge, and another decade to reach the rank of a district and sessions judge.

Fleeting opportunity

By the time an officer enters the zone of considera-

Uphill climb

Judges elevated from subordinate courts comprise less than one-third of the sanctioned strength of several HCs

High Court	Sanctioned strength	Current strength	Elevated from judicial services
Tripura	5	4	2
Himachal Pradesh	17	15	6
Delhi	60	50	19
Bombay	94	75	16
Orissa	33	17	5
Telangana	42	27	5
Uttarakhand	11	8	1
Sikkim	3	2	0

Source: Department of Justice website
Data as of September 1; Delhi figures as of September 27

tion for elevation to the High Court, they are often in their late fifties, leaving them with just a few years before reaching the retirement age of 62.

This progression bottleneck also severely restricts their presence in the Supreme Court. The current

one-third norm has also not been achieved in most States. Across the country's sanctioned strength of 1,114 High Court judges, only 233 judges elevated from the district judiciary are currently in office.

The High Courts of Tripura (40%), Himachal Pradesh (35.29%) and Delhi (31.67%) exceed or come close to meeting the norm, even as other States lag far behind. Service judges constitute just 9.09% in the High Courts of Uttarakhand and Chhattisgarh, 11.90% in Telangana, 15.15% in Odisha and 17.02% in Bombay HC. Sikkim currently has zero representation from State Judicial Services.

In 2023, an application was moved by the Judicial Service Association of Delhi before the Supreme Court seeking a direction

to fill 50% of the seats in the High Court from the service quota.

However, in the order passed on April 25 of that year, a Bench of Justices B.R. Gavai, Vikram Nath and Sanjay Karol stated it was "not inclined to consider the prayer, leaving it open to the applicants to pursue the remedies before such forum as is permissible in law". It directed the High Courts to recommend names from the service cadre before vacancies arose, noting that service judges often had only a few years of tenure in the High Courts.

Attracting talent

Former Principal District and Sessions Judge Pawan Kumar Jain told *The Hindu* that the lack of clear career progression discourages top law graduates from

joining the lower judiciary.

"If after serving 20 to 30 years one fails to reach the High Court at a reasonable age, the system will fail to attract brilliant minds. The institution must prioritise the litigant and fill vacancies efficiently," he said.

Justice Gauba argued that filling High Court vacancies from the service cadre is significantly faster.

"With judicial officers, performance appraisals, integrity reports, and decades of judgment records are already available. Recommendations can be processed months in advance without leaving vacancies open for years. By reserving a disproportionate share for the Bar, we are ultimately depriving citizens of judges who are trained, experienced, and ready to deliver prompt justice," he added.

INBRIEF



Two arrested after bike enters
convoy of V-P in Keralam

Two people have been arrested after a motorcycle allegedly entered the convoy of Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan near Kovalam during his visit to Thiruvananthapuram, Keralam, on Sunday. The Kanjiramkulam police identified the accused as Ashkar and Nadirsha, both of whom hail from Vallakkadavu. The two were allegedly under the influence of alcohol at the time of the incident. An investigation into the incident is under way. The police are examining the circumstances that led to the security lapse.

Elephant kills 60-year-old on
morning walk in Bengaluru

A 60-year-old man, who was on his morning walk with his daughter, was killed in an elephant attack near Mysuru Road in Bengaluru. The victim was identified as Nagaraju. N.R. Kamble, Range Forest Officer, Kaggalipura Range, said that the elephant reached the spot from the Bannerghatta Wildlife Sanctuary. “Our team is tracking the elephant,” he said. Deputy Conservator of Forests Y. Chakrapani said that steps would be taken to ensure that elephants do not stray beyond the Bannerghatta division.

Four women labourers killed
in accident in Telangana

Four women labourers were killed and three others were injured after a lorry collided head-on with the autorickshaw in which they were travelling in Mancherial district of Telangana on Monday. Minister G. Vivek Venkataswamy, expressed grief over the deaths and announced a financial aid of ₹25,000 each to the families of the deceased and ₹10,000 each to the injured.

Rain damages roads, crops in
A.P.; 71,700 farmers affected

Flood alerts issued for hundreds of villages in the State; in Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema district, people in island villages advised to vacate and avoid crossing the Godavari by traditional boats

Hareesh P.
VISAKHAPATNAM

Amid heavy rain induced by the deep depression over the Bay of Bengal, the Godavari Delta and Godavari Valley in Andhra Pradesh are bracing for floods for the second time in six days.

On Monday, the Sir Arthur Cotton Barrage at Dowleswaram in Rajamahendravaram continued to receive more than 9.7 lakh cuses of water.

According to initial estimates, the rain damaged horticultural crops in over 1,734 hectares and agricultural crops in around 44,029 hectares.

State Agriculture Minister K. Atchannaidu said horticultural crops were affected in 89 mandals and 351 villages across 14 districts in Andhra Pradesh.



Severe damage: The paddy crop submerged in floodwater at a village in Srikakulam district of Andhra Pradesh on Monday. V. RAJU

According to preliminary estimates prepared by the Agriculture Department, crops in 1,229 villages across 190 mandals were damaged, affecting an estimated 71,796 farmers.

Roads and Buildings Minister B.C. Janardhan Reddy said an estimated 2,405 km of roads were damaged across the State, with the preliminary restoration

cost being put at ₹1,498.30 crore. The greatest extent of damage was reported in Srikakulam district, where 412 km of roads were affected, he said.

In Polavaram district, which is nestled between the Sabari and the Godavari, flood alerts have been issued for 171 villages. “As many as 55 motorboats and eight launches are

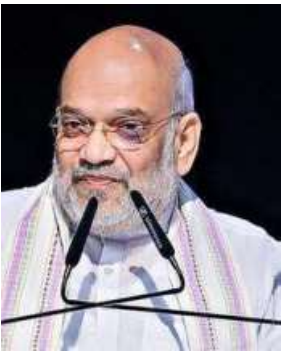
kept ready at Kunavaram and V.R. Puram for relief operations. By Monday, 17 habitations have been submerged,” said Integrated Tribal Development Agency Project Officer Subham Nokwal.

In Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema district, people in island villages have been advised to vacate and avoid crossing the Godavari by traditional boats.

In North Andhra, floodwaters are slowly receding in several villages of Srikakulam district. However, crops in Santabommali, Polaki, Meliaputti, Jalumuru and Burja villages were inundated by floodwaters from Vamsadhara, Nagavali, Bahuda and other rivers. The total loss was expected to be around ₹150 crore. At Allina in Burja mandal, paddy fields in 1,100 acres have been damaged.

Shah to chair meeting
to resolve Mahanadi
water-sharing dispute

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR



Amit Shah

Union Home Minister Amit Shah will preside over a meeting on October 1 to discuss the resolution of the Mahanadi river water-sharing dispute between Odisha and Chhattisgarh, with the Chief Ministers of both States expected to present their positions.

Mr. Shah's meeting is expected to build confidence and trust between the two States so that a final resolution can be achieved and accepted, Odisha's Advocate General Pitamabar Acharya said on Monday. “Apart from the Chief Ministers, Chief Secretaries and Chief Engineers of Water Resources Department of both States will be present at the meeting,” Mr. Acharya added.

On July 30, Union Jal Shakti Minister C.R. Patil had chaired a high-level meeting to resolve the issue. For a decade, both States have been asserting their rights over Mahanadi.

“Engineers from both States have met multiple times to discuss technical issues. They have submitted their reports to the Central Water Commission (CWC), which is the apex body in technical and administrative matters pertaining to river water management in the country. The CWC will submit its report to Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal, headed by former Supreme Court judge Justice Bela M. Trivedi,” said Mr. Acharya.

Mr. Acharya pointed out

that there were examples of court battles that never provided a long-standing resolution to river water disputes. “After Bharatiya Janata Party came to power in Odisha, we informed the tribunal that both States should be given opportunity to sit together and talk directly on the contentious issues. The tribunal agreed,” he said.

Regulatory body

Mr. Acharya said the resolution that would emerge from both political and technical negotiations could be the best result. There could be a regulatory body for Mahanadi that will decide river water-sharing. “The tribunal will take the final decision,” he added.

According to the Odisha government, Chhattisgarh built more than 500 anicuts and 30 barrages on the Mahanadi river after 2010. The previous Naveen Patnaik-led government demanded that upstream construction be halted and sought a definitive water-sharing formula, arguing that Odisha was critically dependent on the river.

Beats of an old custom fade
away from Keralam's courts

Abdul Latheef Naha
PALAKKAD

The drumbeat that once carried royal orders through village streets, and later announced the attachment of properties, will no longer be heard outside Keralam's courts. The archaic practice is now set to pass into history.

The Kerala High Court's Rules Committee has decided to remove the provision for the traditional “tom-tom” and “kinnam mutti vilambaram” used to inform the public about property attachment proceedings. The change fol-

lows a campaign by rights activist Boban Mattumanta, who questioned the need for a colonial-era practice at a time when notices, newspapers, television and social media can reach far more people.

The tom-toming tradition goes back to the days of princely rule. When the king had an order to announce, officials would gather people in markets and other public places. A drumbeat would draw attention before the order was read out. The British later adopted a similar method to make property attachment proceedings

public. The practice continued under Sub-rule 2 of Rule 54 of Order XXI of the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908. While drum-beating had largely disappeared from district courts in Palakkad, Thiruvananthapuram, Ernakulam and Kozhikode, the beating of a metal plate continued in some places. The announcements were also entered in court records.

With the provision now being removed, a practice that began with royal proclamations and survived through the colonial and modern judicial systems is finally falling silent.

Karnataka to submit report on drought situation soon

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Karnataka government is expected to submit its final memorandum on the prevailing drought to the

Centre in the first week of October, after the monsoon ends on September 30.

Deputy Chief Minister G. Parameshwara said the ground-truthing exercise was currently under way in

several taluks, following which the final memorandum detailing the extent of losses and the compensation sought would be submitted to the Centre. He added that the three

Inter-Ministerial Central Teams arriving in Karnataka on October 3 for a drought study would assess the situation based on the first memorandum submitted to the Centre.

Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar announced that an all-party meeting would be convened to discuss the drought situation and the Kasturirangan Committee report.

Office of
Executive Engineer B&R Division HP.PWD. Joginder Nagar
Himachal Pradesh Public Works Department, Mandi-175015
Phone & Fax No. 01908-222033 E-Mail:- ee-jog-hp@nic.in

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, B&R Division, HPPWD, Joginder Nagar on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh invited the online bids on percentage rate, in electronic tendering system, in 2 cover system for the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors/firms registered with HPPWD department for the works as detailed in table.

Sr. No	Name of work	Estimated cost (in lac)	Starting Date of downlaoding Bid.	Earnest Money (in lac)	Eligible class of contractor	Deadline for submission of bid	Date of opening of bid
1.	Construction of breast wall at km.0/230 to 0/240 and wire crated Retaining wall at km. 0/290 to 0/307.50 and 2/422.50 on Restoration of Rain damages of Suin Bhararpatt Gangotri road. Construction of Retaining wall at km 2/225 to 2/263 on Restoration of rain damages on Simus Gwalia road km 0/0 to 3/000 Construction of Retaining wall at km 0/600 to 0/620 breast wall at Rd 0/930 to 0/950 & retaining wall at RD 1/960 to 1/978, breast wall at RD 3/300 to 3/318 & 3/600 tp 3/617 on Restoration of rain Damages on Arla Lahla Bhalara road km 0/0 to 4/000.construction of retaining wall at km 0/700 to 0/415 , 2/365 to 2/375, 4/165 to 4/183 and Breast wall at km 0/00 to 0/015 and 3/825 to 3/840 on Restoration of rain Damages on Bagora Bagla Sanehar Hard Ropri Mordugh Chandani Tikru road km 0/00 to 14/00, Providing and laying Kharanja Soling and cement concrete pavement at km 1/00 to 1/350 on restoration of rain Damages on link road Dak Sihral. construction of breast wall at km 1/655 to 1/675 and 1/640 .40 to 1/655 on restoration of rain damages on Flagla to Salan Dhar. Providing and laying Kharanja Soling & Cement Concrete Pavement at km 0/00 to 0/346 on restoration of rain damages on Chir Bhayotu road km 0/00 to 2/000. Construction of 6.00 mtr. Span RCC Slab culvert at km. 0/350 and retaining wall at km. 4/950 to 4/960 on restoration of rain Damages on Badoun Pipli road km. 0/0 to 12/600, Construction of breast wall and wire crated retaining wall at km.3/530 to 3/547.50 and wire crated breast wall at km 3/750 to 3/767.50 on Restoration of rain Damages on Kuni Katkal Bhalara Rains road. Construction of breast wall at km 5/520 to 5/540, 6/310 to 6/320 and 8/715 to 8/745 and U-shape drain at km 8/00 to 8/620 on Restoration of rain Damages on Challanu to Draman via Golwan road km 0/00 to 8/760. construction of retaining wall at RD /530 to 0/539, breast wall at Rd. 0/855 to 0/870 & Retaining wall at RD 2/855 to 2/862.60 on Restoration of rain Damages on Khaddar Khuddi road km. 0/0 to 8/0. Construction of retaining wall at RD 0/070 to 0/075 & Tarring at km 0/0 to 0/200, 0/500 to 0/700 & 1/600 to 2/655 on Restoration of rain Damages on link road to Raktal km .0/0 to 3/0 under PDNA2023 (12No. road).	Rs. 2,17,98,745/-	01-10-2026	Rs. 436000/-	Class-C	12-10-2026	13-10-2026

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in.

Executive Engineer,
B&R Division HPPWD,
Joginder Nagar
District Mandi (HP) on behalf of
+Governor of (H.P.) 01908222033

HP / 3712/26-27

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Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

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FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR THE HINDU Young World THE HINDU

AMARAVATI GROWTH and INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED (AGICL)
2nd FLOOR, APCRDA PROJECT OFFICE, RAYAPUDI, THULLURU MANDAL, GUNTUR DISTRICT (A.P.)

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

NIT.No. 20/MD/CE-2/AGICL/2026 Date 28-09-2026
Bids are invited for the work "Construction of Neighbourhood Retail Centre at Amaravati Government complex (AGC), Lingayapalem Village, Amaravati through EPC (Design & Build) mode". The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from 30-September-2026 15:00 Hrs For further details, please refer to www.apecprocurement.gov.in and www.agicl.org.
Sd/- Managing Director, AGICL, Amaravati

Government of Tamil Nadu
TAMIL NADU e-GOVERNANCE AGENCY (TNeGA)

2nd Floor, P.T. Lee Chengalvarayan Naicker Maaligai,
807, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600 002
www.tnega.tn.gov.in | +91-44-40164907 |
Email: tenders.tnega@tn.gov.in | GST-33AABTT6381N1ZZ

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender No: TNeGA/OT/CBTE/01/2026-2027

TNeGA invites Tender for empanelment of vendors for conducting "Computer Based Test for various government Agencies". For complete details, please visit <https://tntenders.gov.in>. Pre-bid meeting: 08.10.2026, 11:30 AM at TNeGA Office. Last date for submission of e-bids: 29.10.2026, 04:00 PM. Date of opening of technical bids: 29.10.2026, 04:30 PM. For queries: tenders.tnega@tn.gov.in
DIPR/2967/Tender/2026 GENERAL MANAGER

AMARAVATI GROWTH and INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED (AGICL)
2nd Floor, APCRDA Project Office, Rayapudi, Thulluru Mandal, Guntur Dist. (A.P.)522237.

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

Sl. No.	Name of the Work	NIT No.
1.	Providing Electrical, HVAC, Firefighting System, Lifts, Fire Alarm, Detection & Public Address System, ELV (Structured Cabling System) and Plumbing works for Legislative Assembly Building in Super block, "E" of Amaravati Govt. Complex Area in Amaravati Capital city, Andhra Pradesh".	NIT No. 21/MD/CE(ELE)/AGICL/2026, Date: 28.09.2026
2.	"Providing MEP like high side Electrical, HVAC, Fire Fighting, Lifts, Plumbing Works and ELV works to the High Court Building in Super Block "F" Amaravati Government Complex Area in Amaravati Capital City, Andhra Pradesh".	NIT No. 22/MD/CE(ELE)/AGICL/2026, Date: 28.09.2026

The bids can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from 30-09-2026. For further details, please refer to www.apecprocurement.gov.in and www.agicl.org.
Sd/- Managing Director, AGICL, Amaravati

Govt. of Bihar

Office of the Executive Engineer
Master Planning Investigation & Project Preparation Division-1,
Room No.-503, 5th Floor, Block A, Jal Sansadhan Bhawan, Anisabad, Patna-800002,
Water Resources Department, Government of Bihar
Email Id:-eeapipdp1@gmail.com
Short Notice Invitation
Request for Proposal
for

Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Flood Management, Embankment Strengthening, River Training, Land Recovery and Development of the Ganga River Corridor in Bihar.

Tender/ RFP No.:11/गंगा/ Ganga-RFP-

1. Executive Engineer, Master planning Investigation & Project Preparation Division -1, WRD, Government of Bihar (Authority) invites this RFP proposals from eligible and experienced agencies for Selection of Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Flood Management, Embankment Strengthening, River Training, Land Recovery and Development of the Ganga River Corridor in Bihar.

Particulars	Bid processing Fees inclusive of GST (Non-refundable)	Bid Document Cost (Non-refundable)	Bid Security (EMD)
Selection for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Flood Management, Embankment Strengthening, River Training, Land Recovery and Development of the Ganga River Corridor in Bihar.	Rs. 1180/- (As applicable as per e-PROC Bid Processing Fee Structure)	INR 10,000/- (INR Ten Thousand only)	INR 2,00,000/- (INR Two Lakh only)

2. Date of downloading of bid document

: From 01.10.2026 to 14.10.2026 up to 03:00 PM

3. Place & Date of Pre-bid meeting (both online and in person attendance permitted)

: Date 09.10.2026 at 12:30 PM Meeting hall of Chief Engineer, Master Planning Investigation and Project Planning, Water Resources Department, Jal Sansadhan Bhawan, Anisabad, Patna- 800002, Bihar.

4. Last date and time for receipt of bids on eproc2.

: Date 14.10.2026 at 3:00 PM

5. Time and Date of opening of technical bids

: Date 14.10.2026 at 3:30 PM, through website: <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>

6. Time and Date of financial bids

: To be Communicated later on

7. Bid Submission

: Through website: <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>

8. Period of bids validity

: 120 days

9. Officer inviting bids

: Executive Engineer, Master planning Investigation & Project Preparation Division-1, Anisabad, Patna- 800002

10. For participating in the e-tendering process, the bidder shall have to get them selves registered to obtain a User ID, Password and Digital Signature. This will enable them to access the website <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in> and download/participate in the e-tender.

11. All tender-related queries shall be communicated at Email id- eeapipdp1@gmail.com.

For further details please visit website state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
PR- 012555 (W R D) 2026-27 (Sheo Bachan Kumar), Executive Engineer.
नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी पखिरा

CMVK A ND-NDE



Light on truth

No government intent on working for the people should fear transparency

Protests by political parties and transparency activists have derailed the surreptitious rollout, in Tamil Nadu, of a regressive decision to exempt the Public (Law and Order) Department from the purview of the Right to Information Act, 2005. On September 21, the State government issued a Government Order (G.O.) exercising powers under Section 24 (4) of the RTI Act to notify the department as an “intelligence and security organisation” to which the provisions of the Act shall not apply. While the G.O. surfaced in the public domain only on September 27, strikingly, the Public Department’s designated authorities under the RTI Act had instantly begun citing it to deny information to applicants as early as September 22. This betrayed a system that is shy of investing in transparency. Unsurprisingly, State Law Minister C.T.R. Nirmalkumar was initially defensive about the government’s unilateral decision, which, in any case, required the State to have it placed before the legislature (Section 24 (5), RTI Act). He claimed that the ambit of the exemption was not sweeping enough to shield the entire department, but was intended to prevent the sharing of sensitive information relating to district-level inquiries into incidents of communal clashes and the like. However, shortly thereafter, he announced the G.O.’s withdrawal, without explaining why.

While the State’s afterthought is welcome, the episode has again exposed the political class’s penchant for maintaining secrecy in administrative affairs. Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, whose promise of change came as a breath of fresh air, should have known better. It is concerning that the establishment desired to insulate itself from transparency by amending an Act which, in any case, emphatically enables non-disclosure of information through a long list of exemptions under Section 8. Even otherwise, designated information officers of central/State institutions have displayed an uncanny skill in being economical with the truth, delaying responses or bouncing off queries from RTI Act applicants, citing vague reasons. Besides, concerns about the Digital Personal Data Protection Act diluting the RTI Act further have been widely articulated. It is worrying that the Satrak Nagrik Sangathan’s 2024-25 report card on Information Commissions found a backlog of over 41,000 appeals and complaints before the Tamil Nadu State Information Commission (TNSIC), as of June last year. Yet, the TNSIC is functioning with only half of its sanctioned eight Information Commissioners and has no Chief Information Commissioner. Instead of seeking to defeat the intent of a piece of legislation enacted to empower citizens with access to information, the Tamil Nadu government would do well to strengthen the TNSIC. After all, only an administration that does not fear transparency can be the true harbinger of change.

Waves of rain

Odisha must prepare for repeated bouts of intense downpour

Odisha is experiencing one of its most intense monsoons, recording 1,453 mm of rainfall between June and September 25 this year, a 29% excess. The reason is the unusually large number of atmospheric systems, including 11 over the Bay of Bengal, the latest making landfall near Kalingapatnam on September 23. The IMD had forecast that India would receive 90% of the long-period average partly because an El Niño was expected to develop; the State had finished June itself with a 47% deficit. However, rainfall in the region came to be dominated by the weather systems, which also repeatedly delivered rain without giving locals time to recover. By the State’s estimates, 5.2 lakh people had been affected by July 30 and another 13.5 lakh by August 27. At least 60 locations have so far received more than 100 mm of rain in 24 hours, with the runoff swelling multiple rivers and threatening more floods downstream, including in Bhadrak and Jajpur, and landslides in hilly areas. When a previous bout of rain has already saturated the soil and topped local storage, a new bout could lead more immediately to runoff. While the State’s south is predominantly highland and confronts slope failure risks, its coast is a depositional plain of multiple deltas, rendering a terrain with low gradient through which water does not readily drain into the sea.

The efficacy of the State’s long-standing policy to have zero casualties remains to be seen, especially given the extent to which the ongoing season will stress the drain design and maintenance deficiencies that the CAG had flagged in 2024. Other important data include the eventual crop and infrastructure damage assessments and the peak levels of the Baitarani, Budhabalanga, Jalka, and Rushikulya rivers after the 11th system fades. A study in May by the Odisha University of Agriculture and Technology, based on data from 1901-2020, reported that both maximum one-day and five-day rainfall bursts were becoming more common even as the frequency of heavy-rain days was dipping. The State has been renowned for its disaster management protocols. However, the recurrent waterlogging in urban hubs such as Berhampur and the disruption of inter-State highways and rail networks suggest that its evacuation protocols outpace its civic engineering, with significant room to improve socio-economic and infrastructural resilience. Climate change is also increasingly correlated with more protracted monsoon withdrawal and intense rain events. Taken together, Odisha needs to pivot from anticipating isolated seasonal anomalies to preparing for repeated intense downpours.

It may be tempting to see the recent jerky resumption of negotiations between the Islamic Republic of Iran (IRI) and the United States as *déjà vu*. Similar attempts resulted in the June 17 Memorandum that unravelled within weeks, and the two belligerents resumed their respective blockades of the Strait of Hormuz and Iranian ports.

A different moment now

So, what is different this time? They have both realised that time is not on their side. Their respective domestic considerations make continuation of the seven-month-old war costly and unsustainable. In the short run, going by the past pattern, September 26 saw United States President Trump’s dismissal of Iran’s seven-point proposal, which may be an opening gambit seeking better terms and sequencing. While the Iranian initiative may betray their economic desperation, it also showcases their reasonableness to the Trump sceptics in America and the region who regard his “War of Choice” against Iran as ill-begotten.

The November 3 mid-term congressional elections could upend Mr. Trump as a lame duck. Iranian hardliners, too, need to exhaust this option to justify their aggressiveness. In the longer run, Mr. Trump needs to salvage his legacy to match his extravagant promises. Similarly, the Iranian theocrats need to keep Gen Z engaged and avoid regional blowback from the coagulating mistrust. Thus, while retaining their braggadocio about final victory, each needs to move away from its maximalist obduracy and seek a “Hudna” or temporary peace. The impact of the unfolding imbroglío on the two belligerents as well as on Israel and Gulf states must be examined.

Statistically, the U.S. has a quantitative premium and staying power *vis-à-vis* Iran: It has three times the population, 85 times the GDP and 20 times the military budget. Iran is also at a disadvantage in quality and modernity of weaponry, although its asymmetric strategy has blunted that edge. Washington has weaponised ‘Operation Economic Outcast’ against the already “maximum sanctioned” Iranian economy. Yet, the IRI has not “capitulated”, and the U.S. itself faces inflation, ammunition depletion and isolation. Battle asymmetry aside, their respective combat histories are relevant. The Iran war has been an outlier from the usual U.S. military doctrine of battle dominance through “shock-and-awe”, tech superiority, and leveraging its global primacy through the global politico-financial architecture. The last battle that the U.S. fought as an underdog was its war of independence nearly 250 years ago, and hubris haunts it now. In contrast, Iranians have often been the underdogs to Greeks, Byzantines, Arabs and Ottomans. More recently, British and American manipulation for oil, and Iraq’s 1980 invasion of a fledgling IRI, still frame Iranian



Mahesh Sachdev

Retired Indian Ambassador, specialising in West Asian and oil issues

Both Tehran and Washington must hear the bells toll as mistrust grows and global economies falter

political discourse. Their Shia sect being a minority among the Sunni Muslims reinforces their sense of virtues in suffering and martyrdom. The legacy has made the IRI more determined to face enemies with grit, guile and gumption.

The political ecosystem in Iran is hardened, with dissent stifled and externalised to demonised America and Israel as the two Satans. Mr. Trump has been less successful in getting Americans and the allies abroad behind his trenchant anti-Iran rhetoric. This is partly due to his divisiveness, lack of coherent endgame strategy and inability to protect his allies’ security and economy. Triggering a decapitating war that ignored Iranian politico-military resilience and retaliatory capacity was a strategic blunder. It risked the closure of the two vital maritime choke points, rising hydrocarbon prices, and threatened to push American “hyperpower” into a forever conflict against a middle-ranked, but determined, Iran. Similarly, his recent strategy of inflicting economic pain on Iranians may also fail by making them rally around the flag. Occasional tanker attacks and the ongoing Yemen-Saudi scrimmage notwithstanding, seven months on, the two belligerents are currently licking their wounds.

Uncertain path ahead

Two formidable unknowns loom before some educated projections can be made about the U.S.-Iran conundrum. First, although the Iranian seven-point proposal is based on the June 17 Islamabad memorandum, its precise contents are foggy. Second, the failure of the Islamabad memorandum, subsequent tit-for-tat attacks, the U.S. blockade, Operation Economic Outcast and fire-eating rhetoric since June 17 have deepened mutual mistrust, raising the bar for the *modus vivendi* required for a peace deal. These negatives are balanced by awareness that the continued stalemate would lead to a shared perdition of a hostile Congress blockading Mr. Trump and anti-establishment demonstrations pulling the rug under the Mullahs.

Under a positive scenario, both sides can breathe easier and develop greater mutual empathy. Failure of the June 17 Grand Bargain would have presumably made them more realistic and incremental. So, instead of a race to the bottom, each would need to reluctantly adopt a “Live and Let Live” approach. Despite Mr. Trump’s rejection, signs, such as the Iranian leaders extending their stay in New York, Tehran’s flexibility about controlling the Strait of Hormuz and the use of Qatari mediation instead of alacritous Pakistani generals, seem tentatively positive. To be effective and beneficial to both sides, the deal would have to last at least till November 3, the election date.

Even if this band-aid deal allows the two belligerents to staunch the haemorrhage temporarily, what guarantees its long-term sequel, say, after the Congressional elections? The

IRI and the U.S. are certain to use the interregnum to “recharge their batteries” and get ready for the next round. Their mutual scepticism and contentious issues such as the nuclear and missile programmes, and the proxy non-state actors could impede any progress towards permanent normalisation. A “high noon” can be expected by mid-November.

The sequel would depend on which of the two belligerents is able to hold his flock together. An inherently unpredictable Mr. Trump may only suspend the gamut of anti-Iran measures and keep his forces deployed in the region. Similarly, Iran is unlikely to let go of control of the Strait of Hormuz as future deterrence. To dissuade him from resuming military kinetics, Iran has already unveiled its possible escalatory ladder that includes advanced weaponry, a possible al-Houthi blockade of Bab al-Mandeb, retaliatory attacks on America’s Gulf allies and hints of pre-emptive strikes. Simultaneously, Tehran has sought a regional diplomatic reset through an interim supervisory arrangement with Oman on the Strait of Hormuz, to be endorsed by other Gulf littoral states.

Wider regional consequences

The past two years have brought Israel and Iran into two direct no-holds-barred wars. Intense drone and missile attacks have convinced Israeli public opinion that Iran constitutes an existential threat. On its part, Iran is unlikely to forgive the Lesser Satan for the assassination of its last Supreme Leader. Their resultant intense regional geopolitical competition, particularly in the Levant, would outlast any Tehran-Washington peace deal, giving their two-millennia-old civilisational animus a new edge. Although the October 27 Knesset elections may see hawkish anti-Iran Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu replaced, any successor is likely to be hostile to an Iran pursuing a nuclear duality. Iran can be expected to rely on its proxies and asymmetric arsenal to create a balance of power with Israel equipped with state-of-the-art U.S. weapons. In the long run, time would favour the one with better innovative skills. While Israel is a “Startup Nation”, Iran has also been impressively inventive under pressure.

Other regional countries in the Arabian Peninsula, Iraq and Jordan, were caught in the crossfire and suffered considerable collateral damage under Iranian retaliation. Their hydrocarbon exports and other economic activities have been stifled. In most cases, their extensive forex reserves are likely to help them tide over the turbulence. However, their long-standing security reliance on the U.S. would call for a thorough reappraisal. Among the uncertainties they need to tackle is the future of oil, now more tightly tied to geopolitics than the supply-demand equilibrium.

In this war, “time” has emerged as an element even more slippery and opaque than oil.

Tackling food loss and waste — India’s opportunity

Food loss and waste remain one of the world’s most persistent challenges, with severe consequences for climate, food security, economic costs, and sustainable use of natural resources. India produces enough to feed its population of 1.4 billion, yet a significant share of its produce is lost across the value chain. As the country advances towards more resilient, sustainable and efficient agrifood systems, tackling food loss and waste can deliver a triple win: strengthening food security and nutrition, reducing pressure on natural resources and emissions, and improving incomes and productivity. The International Day of Awareness of Food Loss and Waste, observed annually on September 29, highlights this opportunity for India.

India has already taken the first step by generating nationally representative data.

India’s evidence base, a global first

India is the only country to have conducted three national post-harvest loss surveys. The Ministry of Food Processing Industries assessed losses across 45, 45 and 54 commodities in 2005-07, 2012-14 and 2020-22, respectively, covering the supply chain from farm to retail. The process for a fourth round is now under way.

This sustained effort supports its reporting of the Food Loss Index under the Sustainable Development Goals. However, these estimates cover mainly losses on the farm and in the supply chain. Data on food waste in retail, in hotels and restaurants, and at household level remains far less developed.

The Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) is working with the government, research and financial institutions



Konda Reddy Chavva

Officer-in-Charge, FAO Representation in India

Cutting food losses can strengthen food security, conserve resources and advance climate goals

across India’s agrifood systems to translate the triple win from theme to practice. Generating evidence, testing technologies and mobilising investment from farm to market to the city have been the core of these initiatives.

When food is lost, so are the resources used to produce it. Reducing losses can help India meet its climate and resource-efficiency goals while strengthening food security. The scope for reducing losses is greatest with better storage, drying, cooling, moisture management and processing. Digital tools such as traceability systems can further improve how food is moved and managed through the supply chain.

Food loss and waste need to be integrated more systematically into agricultural planning, food-processing strategies, climate action and investment decisions. This means directing finance towards technologies and infrastructure where they can have the greatest impact, while ensuring that solutions remain affordable and accessible to farmers, producer organisations and small businesses. Circular approaches can add another dimension. Surplus food can be redistributed, while unavoidable organic residues can be converted into compost, biogas or energy, reducing waste and creating additional economic value.

Wholesale markets, overlooked opportunity

Assessments by the FAO and the National Council of Agriculture Marketing Boards (COSAMB) have found that major wholesale markets can generate up to 100 tonnes of organic waste a day; in some cities as much as a fifth of all urban organic waste reaches landfills. Nationally, this adds up to an estimated 3.5 million tonnes a year. It is no waste stream but a resource base, which if treated, can

offset roughly 3.3 million tonnes of CO₂-equivalent emissions annually, or close to \$30 million in carbon credits.

A 50-tonne-a-day bio-CNG plant in Surat, Gujarat, has been run through a private-sector partnership for over five years and reportedly cuts methane-related emissions by about 7,500 tonnes a year.

India can adapt such models to local conditions, including the commodity mix and infrastructure of different markets. Municipalities and market committees can also improve organic-waste segregation, collection and treatment, while developing markets for compost, biogas and other recovered materials.

Investment and innovation

India must move from individual interventions to a more connected national approach with financing at its core. The FAO and the Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) are linking identified food-loss hotspots with climate-resilient technologies such as drying, moisture control, energy-efficient cooling and storage, while SIDBI is arranging finance to help small and medium enterprises adopt them.

The FAO is also working to equip Indian cities with a practical “Package of Practices” for urban food loss and waste management, giving municipalities the tools to measure, prevent, reduce, redistribute and valorise waste across households, wholesale markets, retail and food service.

India now has the data, technology and viable models to reduce food loss and waste. The priority is to close data gaps, direct investment and make loss reduction part of agricultural, food-processing, urban and climate policy.

inequalities. While women are being empowered on the one hand, the continuing crimes against them on the other are deeply disturbing. The judiciary needs to work on a war footing to ensure that cases involving crimes against women are not delayed.

Balasubramaniam Pavani, Secunderabad

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The 80s nostalgia holds caste bias

On July 17, 1985, an argument at a drinking water tank in Karamchedu, in coastal Andhra Pradesh, turned into a massacre. A Madiga woman objected to a Kamma youth soiling the public drinking water tank her family drank from. By nightfall, six Madiga men were dead and three Dalit women had been raped. The police called it a riot. A civil liberties fact-finding team called it a one-sided massacre. The killings birthed the Andhra Pradesh Dalit Mahasabha and a four-decade argument over whether the Constitution reaches inside a village.

Forty-one years later, our feeds are full of the past; AI-generated images of the 80s. Chiffon sarees against sunlit walls, Ambassadors and Contessas. Thus, India became the No. 1 country for Google's Nano Banana image-generation model, and its signature trend was retro-Bollywood portraits. However, where did this aesthetic come from?

Model or mood board, the source material is the same – film stills, magazine spreads, studio portraits, and family albums. However, in the India of the 1980s, all four belonged to households with money and standing; overwhelmingly *savarna*, urban or landed. In 1983, by the Planning Commission's own estimates, 44.5% of Indians, some 323 million people, lived below the poverty line. In 1980, only about a quarter of households lit their homes with electricity. Parliament enacted the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act only in 1989.

It is not that Dalit and Adivasi lives were not photographed; they were,



Rejimon Kuttappan
is a workers rights advocate

Tests by MIT Technology Review found that GPT-5 chooses the stereotypical answer in 80 of 105 sentences: the clever man is upper caste, and the sewage cleaner is Dalit

but by others – the state took pictures for its welfare files, activists after an atrocity, as well as anthropologists. The family photograph, which is taken simply to be seen, and is the genre nostalgia runs on, was the one the poor could least afford. Those who could reach a photo studio posed before a painted Swiss chalet; the colony and the forbidden tap remained outside the frame.

A model trained on such an archive reproduces the silence, and hardens it. Tests by MIT Technology Review found that GPT-5 chooses the stereotypical answer in 80 of 105 sentences: the clever man is upper caste, and the sewage cleaner is Dalit. A study presented at the ACM's FAccT conference this year analysed 1,536 images from Gemini's image model, the engine behind Nano Banana, prompted with Indian names and no caste labels. Caste surfaced anyway, through food, neighbourhood, work and worship. One image placed a sanitation worker beneath a banner reading “Bhangi Colony”.

Ask the machine for the 1980s and it gives you an upper-caste version. Ask it for a Dalit and it reaches for dirt. The machine did not invent this prejudice; it inherited it and now industrialises it.

A state that looks away
Nobody outside the companies know what is in the training sets. Nor do those who label them (often South Asian workers paid per task to judge which faces look Indian enough). Can a labeller who has never seen a colony flag a model that has never rendered one?

And the government? The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)'s AI Governance

Guidelines name bias and discrimination as risks, and then leans on voluntary codes and self-certification. The Centre has told the Rajya Sabha that no new horizontal AI law is needed at this stage. Meanwhile, the ₹10,371-crore IndiaAI Mission subsidises “sovereign” models. Moreover, Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw has promised that Indian-trained models will be free of “the bias of many other models”. Which bias? Tested how?

A committee is reportedly drafting firmer rules; caste must be written into them. Additionally, the MeitY and the IndiaAI Safety Institute should answer these four questions – what is in the training data? who labelled it? has a caste-bias evaluation been done? will relevant date be published? Anything short of mandatory, public answers is consent by silence.

The counter-evidence is on our screens through films such as *Fandry*, *Kammattipaadam*, *Pariyerum Perumal*, *Vaazhai* etc. What they share is not budget, but authorship. The person remembering has stood on the other side of the water tank. Caste vanishes from nostalgia not because it is subtle but because it is not an object. Caste is who sits where, and who draws from which tap. You cannot buy it as a prop; you will miss it unless it has not shaped your life.

So, do not ban the filter. Go upstream. Ask Dalit, Adivasi, Muslim and working-class families what images they hold from 1975 to 1995, who took them, and what was kept out of frame. Fund community photo archives as seriously as we fund film restoration.

Revisiting the farmer question

India may no longer be an agriculture dominated economy, but it remains deeply dependent on it. While only about 15-18% of GDP now comes from agriculture, the sector continues to employ around 46% of India's workforce. A large part of rural India depends directly on farming and allied activities for its livelihood. This creates an uncomfortable paradox: while India has transformed into an economy driven by industry and services, the economic viability of farming has not kept pace. This is why, as we observe M. S. Swaminathan's death anniversary, the recommendations of the National Commission on Farmers (NCF), which he chaired, need to be revisited.

One of the biggest challenges in Indian agriculture is small landholdings; about 86% of farmers own less than two hectares. Small plots constrain economies of scale, crop diversification and the adoption of new technologies and farming practices. Water is another structural constraint. Around half of all farmed land relies entirely on unpredictable rain, exposing farmers to drought and erratic monsoons. Elsewhere, intensive irrigation has created the opposite problem: groundwater depletion. The Cauvery dispute is ultimately a manifestation of competing demands on a finite resource.

Moreover, climate change is intensifying these vulnerabilities. Erratic rainfall, floods, droughts, and heat waves are increasingly translating into crop losses, while, rising costs of seeds, fertilizers, pesticides, and fuel squeeze farm margins. Farmers often receive only



Priyambada Javakumar
Historian, public speaker, columnist, handloom advocate, and the author of 'The Man Who Fed India'

The challenge is to ensure that greater integration with global markets becomes an opportunity for Indian farmers rather than another source of vulnerability

a miniscule share of the final value of what they produce. Weak storage and processing infrastructure, fragmented supply chains and multiple intermediaries often leave cultivators with little bargaining power.

What the NCF got right
The NCF offered a comprehensive response to many of these problems. Its central insight was that agricultural distress was fundamentally an income and livelihood problem, not merely a productivity problem. Farmer policy, it argued, should be judged by the economic well-being of farmers rather than by increases in production or yield. The Commission, therefore, looked beyond land ownership to timely access to productive resources such as water, credit, technology, livestock, fisheries and other natural resources. It called for closer links between research institutions and cultivators.

Its approach also emphasised ecological sustainability. Higher productivity could not come at the cost of soil health and water security. Efficient water use, sustainable farming practices and conservation of natural resources were integral to agricultural policy.

The NCF also recognised that farmers were at the wrong end of an unequal value chain. It proposed district-level agricultural infrastructure; direct marketing linkages; stronger integration between agriculture and rural industry; and better storage, grading, packaging, processing and transportation. It sought to strengthen farmers' bargaining power. Importantly, the Commission did not assume that everyone

dependent on rural India could or should remain solely dependent on cultivation. It proposed a broader livelihood-security framework encompassing agriculture and allied activities, rural enterprises and non-farm employment.

Over the last two decades, several of NCF's recommendations have been implemented through separate schemes and missions. However, the Commission's larger vision of making farming economically viable, reducing risk, strengthening farmers' bargaining power and integrating production with markets has not been implemented as an integrated framework.

The NCF also anticipated a dilemma that is in sharp focus today: Indian agriculture cannot remain insulated from global markets, but neither can small farmers be exposed to those markets without adequate protection. With India now implementing Free Trade Agreements while also dealing with tariff pressures from the U.S., NCF's ideas have renewed relevance. The challenge is to ensure that greater integration with global markets becomes an opportunity for Indian farmers rather than another source of vulnerability.

The answer is not protectionism, but a combination of remunerative prices, risk management, farmer aggregation, productivity enhancement, value addition, and carefully designed trade safeguards. The task today is not to mechanically reproduce the recommendations, but to update and complete their underlying vision for the agriculture sector.

Gender disparities in contraceptive use and sterilisation

In contrast to 36.5% women reporting sterilisation, only a meagre 0.5% men reported male sterilisation in NFHS-6

DATA POINT

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
Nitika Francis

The World Health Organization (WHO) has issued new guidelines on expanding contraceptive options and, for the first time, set out the benchmarks for a new generation of reversible male contraceptives that could give men more alternatives.

The timing of the announcement is significant for India. After focussing on family-planning policies for decades, fertility has fallen below the replacement level (**Chart 1**). Figures from the latest National Family Health Survey (NFHS-6) for 2023-24, show a decline in the share of married women who have an unmet need for family planning by one percentage point from NFHS-5 for 2019-21.

Yet, the NFHS-6 also shows that the demographic achievement has not altered the gender imbalance in contraceptive responsibility, with both temporary and permanent contraception measures increasingly used/taken by women.

Chart 2 shows an increase in the proportion of currently married women aged 15-49 using any contraceptive method, from 66.7% as per the NFHS-5 (for 2019-21) to 69.1% in 2023-24. Though majority of these women used modern methods of contraception, their use has fallen from 56.4% to 52.7%, while traditional methods – principally rhythm/fertility-awareness and withdrawal – have risen sharply by 6 percentage points between NFHS-5 and NFHS-6, which is the largest increase in the reported use of any contraceptive method between the two surveys.

While the NFHS data do not establish the reason for this increase, possible factors include concerns about side-effects, convenience, privacy, partner preferences, access and a desire to avoid hormonal or invasive methods, with women being the principal users of

such methods.

The decline in the use of modern methods is reflected in female sterilisation as well. Women who are married and reporting female sterilisation came down marginally from 37.9% in NFHS-5 to 36.5% in NFHS-6. Importantly, sterilisation also remains overwhelmingly female. In contrast to 36.5% reporting female sterilisation, only a meagre 0.5% men reported male sterilisation in NFHS-6 – a miniscule increase from 0.3% in NFHS-5. The disparity becomes more striking when the data is viewed over three decades (**Chart 3**). Female sterilisation climbed rapidly between NFHS-1 and NFHS-3 and has remained at around 36-38%; male sterilisation fell from 3.4% in NFHS-1 to 0.5% in NFHS-6.

A look at State-wise figures on male sterilisation shows that even the States that achieved low Total Fertility Rate (TFR) early were not exceptions to this trend. The share of men who used sterilisation as their preferred contraceptive method increased between NFHS-5 and NFHS-6 in 22 States. And yet, none of these States, barring Telangana, saw an increase of more than one percentage point, as shown in **Chart 4**. Numbers indicate that as India moved towards replacement-level fertility, vasectomy or male sterilisation went from a visible component of family planning to a marginal one.

While the sterilisation process for females is not inherently unsafe, the physical intervention required to end fertility is less invasive for men and can be performed under local anaesthesia.

“Choice is a gender equality issue,” said Pascale Allotey, Director of WHO's Department of Sexual, Reproductive, Maternal, Child and Adolescent Health and Ageing, while releasing the new guidelines. WHO said its own research has challenged a longstanding assumption that men would not use new contraceptives. India should leverage the new WHO guidelines to address the gender imbalance.

Unequal responsibility

The data for the charts were sourced from the National Family Health Survey reports released by the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare and Sample Registration System statistical reports. With inputs from Gandla Sneha, who is interning with The Hindu's Data Team



CHART 1: India achieved the goal set in the National Population Policy 2000 for its Total Fertility Rate (TFR) of 2.0 in 2021. It fell to 1.9 in 2025, below replacement level

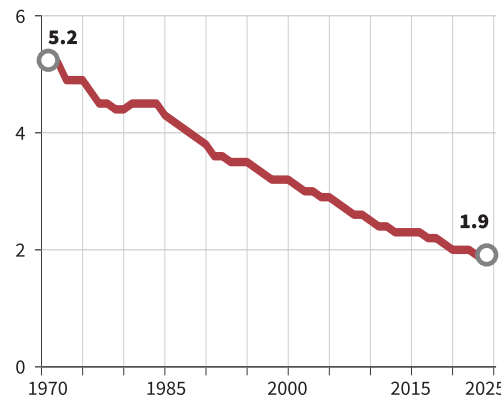
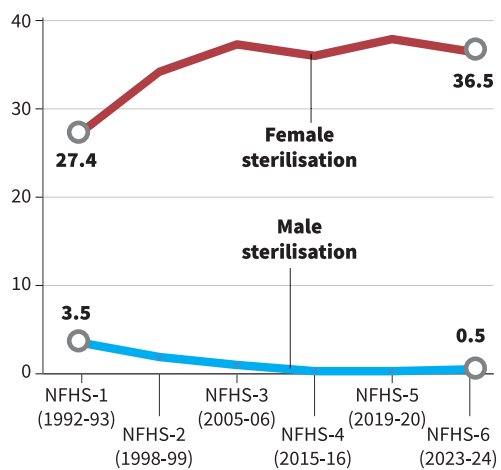


CHART 3: While the share of women undergoing sterilisation has increased, the same has dropped for men from the already abysmal level



WHO has developed its first “Target Product Profile” for male contraceptive methods, setting out the characteristics methods should aim to meet, including safety, effectiveness, acceptability and affordability

CHART 2: A majority of married women used modern methods of contraception, but use of traditional methods have risen sharply. Values outside the bars show the totals

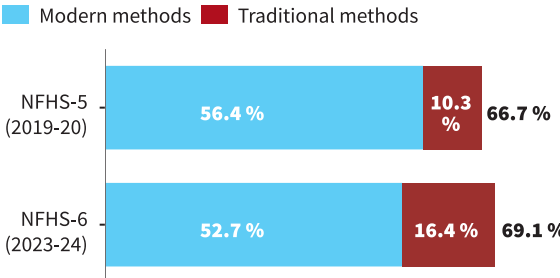
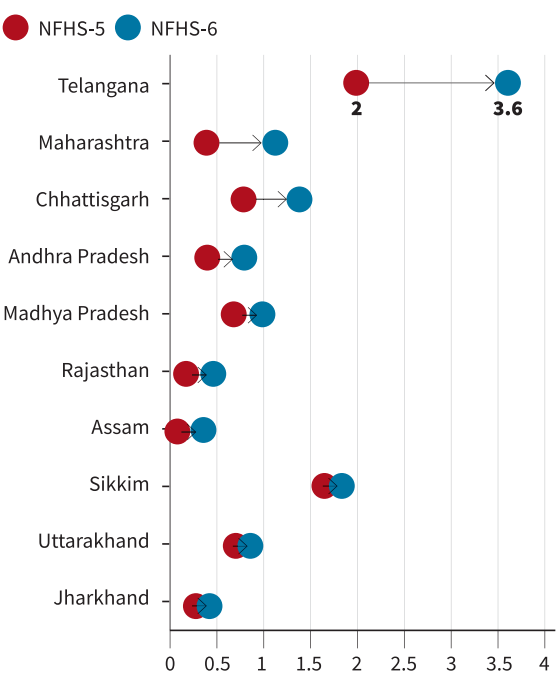


CHART 4: The 10 States that recorded the highest increase in the share (%) of men using sterilisation as their method of contraception. The increase is miniscule as the chart shows



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The **Hindu.**

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 29, 1976

Shukla's tribute to Bharathi

Madras, September 28: The State Government has decided to acquire the house at Triplicane in Madras where the Tamil poet Subrahmanya Bharathi lived during his last days and also to rename Pycrofts Road as Bharathi Salai.

This was announced to-day by the Governor, Mr. Mohanlal Sukhadia, while inaugurating a month-long Son et Lumiere programme on Bharathi at a function presided over by the Minister for Information and Broadcasting, Mr. V.C. Shukla.

The sound and light spectacle entitled “Oru Sakthi Pirakuthu Mochinile” in the courtyard of Rajaji Hall portrays different facets of the poet as a nationalist, journalist, social reformed and devotee. Mr. Shukla said that though the programme was to run for a month, if the response was encouraging, it would not only be prolonged but extended to other parts.

Tamil Nadu had every reason to be proud of Bharathi and the part played by him during the freedom struggle was written in letters of gold. The Governor said that though the poet had lived only for 39 years he has bequeathed to the people a priceless treasure of patriotic poetry which had immortalised him. His patriotic fervour was so great that he poured out his heart in soul-stirring poems. His songs were even-to-day in the lips of young and old of Tamil Nadu and elsewhere. Mr. Sukhadia said that efforts were now being made by the UNESCO to publish a translation of some of Bharathi's important poems.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 29, 1926

Supply of safety razors to British Army

London, September 27: The decision of the War Office to serve out safety razors to soldiers instead of open blades, was raised in Parliament in connection with a contract for the supply of the former made by a company bearing a well-known American name.

Captain King, for the Government, explained that the company with which the arrangement was made was the offshoot of an entirely British character. He mentioned that one condition of the contract was that the Company should take over the War Officer stocks of over hundred thousand long-handled razors in exchange for safety razors.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount earned by MCD from unipole advertisement in 2026

79 in ₹ crore. The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has no records of estimated revenue losses from unallotted or inactive unipole advertising sites across its 12 zones, or of action taken against officials for alleged negligence in tendering or revenue oversight, according to an official response. The civic body has identified 1,235 unipole sites across its 12 zones. PTI

Crimes against women reported in Odisha since June 2024

71,769 As many as 71,769 cases of crimes against women were registered at police stations across Odisha between June 2024 and July 2026, Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi informed the Assembly on Monday. Similarly, 21,069 cases involving crimes against women were registered till the end of July, he said. PTI

Children in India who lack sanitation services in schools

50 in million. Nearly a fifth of the children with no access to sanitation services in schools are in India, the highest for any country in the world, according to the WHO-UNICEF Joint Monitoring Programme (JMP) report. India has 50 million of the world's 244 million children who did not have sanitation services in schools in 2025, the report noted. PTI

Percentage increase in India's industrial output in August

8 in per cent. India's industrial output increased by 8 per cent in August from 7.4 per cent in the preceding month, mainly due to a good show by the manufacturing sector, according to the latest government data released on Monday. The data showed that the mining and quarrying sector contracted by 5.6 per cent in August against 15.8 per cent growth a year ago. PTI

Mobile numbers blocked in Rajasthan due to CSEAM

15,326 The Rajasthan Police have blocked 15,326 mobile numbers, nearly 7,800 URLs and profiles and 100 devices allegedly linked to online circulation of child sexual exploitation and abuse material (CSEAM), a senior official said on Monday. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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A new governance model for Ladakh

Ladakh was made a Union Territory under the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019, prompting concerns from local groups about preservation of Ladakh's culture and demands for Sixth Schedule status; the Centre has proposed to insert Article 371-K into the Constitution to provide for a directly elected legislative body instead

EXPLAINER

C.B.P. Srivastava

The demand by Ladakh for Sixth Schedule status and the proposal made by the Ministry of Home Affairs to provide for a directly elected legislative body for governance in the Union Territory has created a paradoxical situation and raised the question of whether a UT can be granted such status. Whether it would be constitutionally valid to equate States and UTs in the context of their respective governance is a question worth examining. Indian federalism is unique in the sense that, in general, it functions as a federation, while during an Emergency, it becomes perfectly a union. This is why the Supreme Court has called it “Amphibian” in *State of Rajasthan v. Union of India* (1977). This observation signifies that while India intends to distribute the resources equitably through its federal structure, it retains a unitary character to ensure the unity and integrity of the nation.

Moreover, India's territory includes States, UTs and any other territory acquired under international law, making it a decentralised federal design. The political idea behind this design is to include every cultural and ethnic group in democratic governance to sustain its political structure. This has also been the primary reason for the provisions of the Fifth and Sixth Schedules, which provide for Scheduled Areas and Autonomous Districts, especially to ensure the inclusion of tribal communities. From a functional perspective, this design is founded on the ‘Doctrine of Proportionality’, so that the Rawlsian principle of justice, i.e., the greatest advantage to the least advantaged could be achieved. Considering its unique ethnic composition and cultural specificity, Ladakh has demanded Sixth Schedule status. However, the Central Government is unwilling to provide this



A protest demanding Sixth Schedule status for Ladakh, held in Leh in January 2026. ANI

status and has instead proposed an elected legislative authority for a sui generis model of governance.

What is the Sixth Schedule?

The Sixth Schedule covers only Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram primarily because most of these areas were part of Assam during British rule and were classified as “Excluded” or “Partially Excluded” areas. Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram later became separate States, retaining their Sixth Schedule protections. The Sixth Schedule is governed by Article 244(2) and 275(1). The Governor has the power to create new Autonomous Districts through a public notification. Each such district is governed by a district council with a maximum of 30 members. In short, the States covered by the Sixth Schedule enjoy considerable autonomy in governance.

Ladakh was made a Union Territory without a Legislative Assembly under the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act,

2019. Many local groups expressed concerns about protecting the culture of Ladakh's people, including their language, traditions and customary practices. They also wanted to prevent outsiders from acquiring land in Ladakh, as it could deprive local people of their land rights. Above all, local groups are dissatisfied with the way political representation has been given to Ladakh. All these factors have contributed significantly to the demand for Sixth Schedule status.

Proposal of Article 371-K

The Government has proposed to insert Article 371-K in Part XXI of the Constitution (Temporary, Transitional and Special Provisions) to strike a balance between national administration and local self-government. If the Government grants special status under the Sixth Schedule to Ladakh, the autonomy it would receive might prove detrimental to national security, given Ladakh's strategic location in the vicinity of China. However,

the ethno-cultural aspects of Ladakh must also be protected through an efficient and autonomous local government.

Against this backdrop, the proposal to provide a directly elected legislative authority appears more rational, as it would not only ensure adequate and proper political representation but also involve the local population in the decision-making process. The proposed structure may place this body above the existing Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (LAHDCs), while retaining panchayats and district-level institutions. However, the role of the Lieutenant Governor after the constitution of this authority is yet to be clearly defined. Further, the extent of powers that the said authority might enjoy, particularly in terms of financial autonomy, remains to be seen. As India is a functional federation in which financial and residuary powers are vested in the Union rather than the States, it remains to be decided whether the legislative authority would enjoy any such powers.

Constitutionality of the proposal

Granting special status or providing a sui generis model of governance to a Union Territory is certainly constitutionally valid, as India's constitutional governance practices equitable distribution of rights among States and other units within its territory. It also practises the principle of proportionality and may, therefore, provide special powers or status to a UT based on its location, developmental requirements and the need to protect its democratic identity. Earlier, through constitutional amendments, Parliament has made special provisions for the National Capital Territory of Delhi under Articles 239 AA and 239 AB. This makes it clear that Parliament may grant special status to any UT.

Thus, the proposal to insert Article 371-K is expected to provide the required autonomy without adversely affecting the territorial integrity of the nation. (C.B.P. Srivastava is president, Centre for Applied Research in Governance, Delhi)

THE GIST

The Sixth Schedule, which is governed by Article 244(2) and 275(1) provides for the creation of Autonomous Districts. It covers Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram

The Government has proposed to insert Article 371-K in Part XXI of the Constitution (Temporary, Transitional and Special Provisions) to strike a balance between national administration and local self-government

What does Centre's decision on NEET-SS seats entail?

Why did the Central government agree to reduce the qualifying percentile for NEET-SS?

Nivedita S.

The story so far:

In September 17, 2026, the Union government agreed to the Supreme Court's suggestion of reducing the qualifying percentile for the 2025 National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-Super Speciality (NEET-SS) from 50% to 30%. Following this, the Medical Counselling Committee (MCC) commenced a stray round from September 25 to fill the remaining 1,857 vacant seats. The Centre also agreed to give the 40 vacant in-service seats in Tamil Nadu back to the State.

What is the NEET-SS examination?

The NEET-SS is the only entrance examination for admission to DM (Doctorate of Medicine), MCh (Master of Chirurgery), and DrNB (Doctorate of National Board) super-speciality courses

in India. It is conducted by the National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS), an autonomous body under the Union Health Ministry. There are over 7,000 seats in the country, with around 15,000 applicants every year.

NEET-SS is not a single unified examination. The courses offered under it are divided into 15 groups: general medicine, general surgery, orthopaedics, paediatrics, obstetrics and gynaecology, anesthesiology, radiology, respiratory medicine, microbiology, pathology, psychiatry, pharmacology, ENT, critical care, and medical oncology. Each group covers multiple specialty subjects. For example, general medicine covers cardiology, nephrology, neurology, and seven other subjects. Each group has a different question paper and the cut-off for each paper varies.

Why were seats going vacant?

Super-specialisation provides advanced

clinical training and teaching for doctors. In India, it is in high demand in private corporate hospitals. “The market factor plays a big role. Doctors are taking super-speciality seats which give more chances for better practice and more money. If the seats they prefer are not available for their ranks this year, they will try the next time. This is a major reason why seats are going unfilled,” said Dr. Ravindranath, general secretary of Doctors' Association for Social Equality.

Cardiology, neurosurgery, medical oncology, and gastroenterology are among those subjects which are highly competitive with lower vacancies. Seats mostly go vacant in those courses which do not have as much demand. For example, cardiovascular and thoracic surgery has witnessed a drop in demand as medical treatment now relies on drugs and radioactive interventions over surgery. Super-specialisation in paediatric surgery has a lower demand due to

competition from doctors in other specialisations.

In 2023, after 1,003 seats remained vacant, a Supreme Court Bench led by Justices B.R. Gavai and Vikram Nath asked the Centre to find a solution. The Bench called these vacant seats a “wastage of resources”. Following this, the Medical Counselling Committee (MCC) announced that the 2023 candidates with zero percentile were also eligible to secure a seat if they opt for it; however, many seats still remained vacant. In 2024, around 600 NEET-SS seats were vacant after two rounds of counselling, which led to mop-up rounds after court intervention.

What did doctors from T.N. demand?

In 2026, while hearing the case filed by Tamil Nadu Medical Officers Association, the court said the large number of vacancies in the 2025 NEET-SS admissions made the case for reduction of the qualifying percentile “compelling.” The Bench of Justices B.V. Nagarathna and Joymalya Bagchi said access to super-speciality for in-service government doctors must become easier as they are appearing for the exam while providing service to the public at the same time.

Under G.O. Ms. No. 462, Tamil Nadu has reserved 50% of NEET-SS seats for in-service doctors in State medical colleges. This quota was upheld by the Supreme Court in 2022.

In the 2025 cycle, the State had

reserved 219 seats for in-service doctors, of which only 68 were filled. Over 111 candidates remained on the waiting list. In the petition, the Tamil Nadu Medical Officers Association challenged the “premature diversion” of 152 seats reserved for in-service doctors working in State hospitals into the All-India Quota. Senior advocate P. Wilson, for the petitioner, said that many candidates, particularly from rural parts of the State, were awaiting a reduction in the qualifying percentile. This is relevant as there is no caste- or religion-based reservation in this exam. He also sought protection of the in-service quota. This led to the Centre giving 40 vacant seats back to the State.

Is this adequate to address the issue?

“Reducing the cut-off might address this problem to an extent, but it cannot prevent seats from going vacant,” Dr. Ravindranath said. He added that the low number of seats in government hospitals in States like Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, and the northeast is worsening the issue. Along with this, employment and promotion opportunities have not increased for super-specialists. This is because in government hospitals, new departments for such specialisations have not been established. The low stipends and heavy workload in the course are also factors that discourage candidates from pursuing super-specialisation.

Nepal’s flash foods: How can communities rebuild after a disaster?

The state is often quick to respond to disasters, but its approach is usually centralised and top-down, often undermining the role of local bodies, which have greater knowledge of the local context; these bodies need to have a say in issues such as the resettlement of communities

INTERVIEW

Nimesh Dhungana

Kunal Shankar
Nivedita Varadarajan

In August 26, floods hit Nepal’s Rasuwa, Nuwakot and Dhading districts, wiping away entire towns and communities. Roads and bridges were washed away, and telecommunications networks were down. The immediate focus was on rescuing people trapped under debris and providing relief to those affected. A month on, the focus has now shifted to rehabilitation, rebuilding and long-term recovery.

The Hindu spoke to Dr. Nimesh Dhungana, Senior Lecturer in Disaster Studies and Global Health at the University of Manchester’s Humanitarian and Conflict Response Institute (HCRI), who studies disasters through the lens of governance, democracy and accountability, about recovery after the devastating flash floods. Dr. Dhungana describes himself as an accidental disaster researcher who started studying disasters after the 2015 Nepal earthquake. He also studied the Himalayan country’s response to the COVID pandemic. Edited excerpts:

Is there a difference between the way the government responded to the 2015 earthquake, the COVID pandemic and the recent flash floods? The government has a sense of moral responsibility [to save lives] when a disaster of this scale strikes. One common element is that the state acts decisively and with the speed required in the aftermath of such disasters. It mobilises its emergency forces, led by the security forces. However, we are increasingly seeing that the state’s response is not matched by a sustained commitment to long-term recovery and reconstruction. That responsibility starts to fade, particularly when it comes to listening to affected communities and ensuring that their rights are protected. It is about transparency, engagement with the affected population and ensuring that they have a say in the recovery and reconstruction process.

Your work suggests that disasters expose government failures that have built up, or existed long before the disaster itself. What do you mean by this? I think there is a long-standing debate about what constitutes a disaster. The recent floods have also forced us to revisit this basic question: what is a disaster in the first place? One way of thinking about it is as an event that is often unpredictable and attracts considerable attention from national and international media, as the recent floods did. Another way of thinking about a disaster is as a process. It is something that happens because of long-term vulnerabilities. Disasters are not caused by nature alone. I think there is a growing consensus that a disaster is more of a process than just an event. Unfortunately, it is more comfortable to think of a disaster as an event, something beyond our control. We saw that with the 2015 earthquake and the pandemic. This is not



Trail of destruction: Damaged houses covered in sludge in the aftermath of the flash flood in Nepal’s Rasuwa district. AFP

limited to Nepal; it is a wider issue. I think this is a problematic way of looking at disasters. It can absolve state actors of accountability. We need deeper introspection into the choices we make, our governance structures and institutions. We should adopt a more rights-based approach to disaster response and rethink how we address longstanding inequalities and injustices. The state is often quick to respond to disasters, but its approach is usually centralised and top-down. This undermines the roles and responsibilities of local bodies, which are the frontline responders.

How do you balance the role of the local bodies and the federal government, especially when a massive disaster strikes a region, leaving the local communities wiped out? It depends on the scale of the disaster. The flash floods in Nepal are unprecedented. Given the scale of the disaster, Nepal needs support from outside, not just nationally, but also internationally. However, this is no excuse for not involving local representatives in the process. Ward officials, elected representatives, local NGOs and community-based organisations, which are often at the forefront of disaster response, have greater knowledge of the local context. In the Rasuwa floods, questions have been raised about their role being undermined by the centralised disaster response. Mobilising military and security forces for disaster relief is a way of centralisation. We need to think beyond security forces for the immediate response and recovery. We need to engage more civilian actors for immediate relief and in policy-making. We should empower the local government with resources, equipment and infrastructure

to deal with disasters. In the longer term, policy-wise, local bodies need to have a say in answering the big questions, like how we resettle communities. The problem is that, in Nepal and elsewhere, reconstruction tends to focus more on physical reconstruction, like building houses and other infrastructure. But they are often not aligned with community priorities. It also raises a deeper question: what does recovery mean? What if people don’t want to move from a certain place? How do we listen to their claims and choices? The local government can play a really important role here. Your work says there is a difference between the community ‘having a voice’ and ‘having teeth’. What does that mean? This also stems from a more rights-based approach to thinking about development and disasters. There’s a long-standing literature on the role of voice in this kind of difficult situation, going back to Amartya Sen’s work in famine prevention. He did seminal work on how we should think about famine not just as a problem of food production, but also in terms of entitlement failures and whether communities have the right to demand answers from authorities. Be it the 2015 earthquake or the recent Rasuwa floods, bereaved families have demanded answers from the State about the way rescue and relief operations have been organised. There have also been questions about fairness and transparency in relief distribution. This is also about democracy and the responsiveness of State institutions, and whether they listen to these demands. ‘Teeth’ also means having the resources and ability to respond through concrete policy and programmatic interventions. The idea of ‘voice’ and ‘teeth’, comes from scholar Jonathan Fox’s work. I have

drawn on that idea, but also looked at it in the context of disaster. Jonathan Fox talks about how ‘voice’ and ‘teeth’ come together to operate as a ‘bite’. The ‘bite’, in this sense, is concrete measures that would protect the rights and welfare of disaster-affected communities. What should a genuinely good, decentralised, community-led approach to disaster governance look like? At the ward level, disaster management governance committees exist, but only on paper. We need human and financial resources to respond, as well as physical resources such as ambulances, hospitals and relief shelters. Emergency operations are not just about having resources; it is also about the general logic of governance. Disasters are better managed locally, as local governments have knowledge of the local context.

How do we ensure that human decisions do not make disasters even worse? This comes back to who has the power to make decisions. The major casualties of the recent Nepal floods were hydropower and the road networks. Some estimates say that almost 10% of Nepal’s hydropower infrastructure was wiped out. Who granted licenses to construct hydropower projects in these areas? This is fundamentally a question of governance. Decisions about building critical infrastructure, such as schools and hospitals, on riverbanks are linked to human choices.

Do communities that are victims of infrastructural breakdowns have any say? What role did they have in the making of these infrastructures? It is important to have a conversation about the climate crisis, but we also need to examine what happened downstream. What was the government’s role before the disaster? Did it do enough to protect the public? That is where a rights-based, more governance-centric approach to disasters comes in. It also involves a more social scientific approach to understanding disasters, rather than looking at them solely from the perspective of hazards and physical sciences.

How do we plan in such a way as to either avoid a disaster or rebuild after one? There is no single cause of disaster. Some scholars have long called disasters as a wicked problem because they result from a combination of factors, such as natural hazards, risks and vulnerabilities. In the context of climate change, the recent floods in Nepal have made it painfully clear that this issue will become even more important. We need to be thinking about disasters from a multidimensional, interdisciplinary perspective. We have seen many disasters along the Nepal-India border that defy national boundaries. We also need to take a transboundary approach. How do we bring this conversation into policymaking? How do we decentralise disaster governance in a way that gives more power and resources to local bodies? We need accountability and responsibility. The government must listen to communities affected by disasters.



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the origin and meaning of the expression “cock and bull story”? (K. Balaji, Chennai) When you say that someone gave you a “cock and bull story”, what you are implying is that the individual told you a story that was unbelievable; he told you a story that was obviously a lie. People often resort to cock and bull stories when they want to come up with an excuse for not having done something. Here are a few examples. When I asked Namrata why she hadn’t done her assignment, she gave me some cock and bull story about being abducted by aliens. When the Chairman asked for an explanation, all he got from the Vice President was some cock and bull story. There are several explanations as to the origin of this expression. Some scholars believe that the idiom has its origins in the fables that we all read as children; stories in which animals behave and talk like human beings. Such stories are often considered to be unrealistic by people who are very practical in their outlook. They can’t believe that animals like lions, bulls, foxes, etc. can actually talk. Hence the expression “cock and bull story”.

What is the difference between lacto-vegetarian and lacto-ovo-vegetarian? (S. Amarnath, Mysore) A “lacto-vegetarian” is someone who not only eats vegetables but also dairy products like milk, cheese, butter, etc. He doesn’t eat eggs and products made from eggs. A lacto-ovo-vegetarian, on the other hand, is someone who takes both milk and egg products. By the way, a person who eats only vegetables is called a “vegan”.

Which of the following sentences is correct? “Each of the children were given chocolates” or “Each of the children was given chocolates”. (K. Gauri, Tirupati) In such sentences, according to the rules of English grammar “each” should be followed by a singular verb. Therefore your second sentence will meet the approval of a grammarian. Here are a few examples. Each of the books was gift wrapped carefully. Each of the teachers wants to donate a hundred rupees. Nowadays, there is a tendency to use a plural verb instead of the singular one in such constructions. This is especially true in speech. Here are a few examples. Each of his plays have been hits. Each of his ideas are clearly stated.

What is the difference between “stairway” and “staircase”? (D.S. Bhat, Bangalore) Most people tend to use the two words interchangeably. For the common man, steps which allow him to move from one floor to another can be called either a staircase or a stairway. There is no difference between the two. But I understand there are certain technical differences. And one of them is that a staircase usually has a handrail, while a stairway needn’t always have one. Published in The Hindu on February 12, 2002

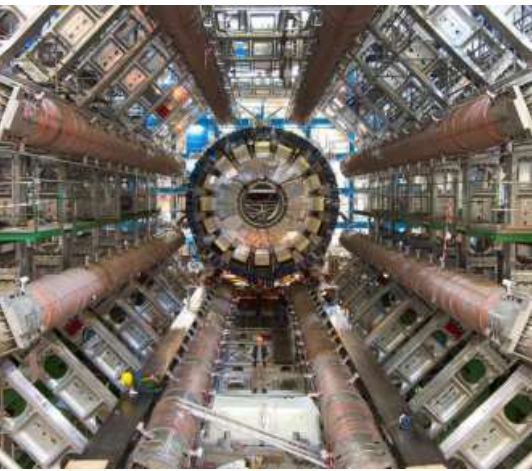
THE DAILY QUIZ

On this day 72 years ago, CERN’s founding convention entered into force. A quiz on the storied science lab

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1 Since 2012, CERN has held ‘observer status’ at the X, allowing it to attend sessions and participate in the work of the organisation, but without having the right to vote. As a result, CERN has been able to contribute scientific and technical expertise central to X’s work. Name X. QUESTION 2 When he was working at CERN, the English scientist _____ invented the World Wide Web. By 1990, he had created the first web browser, server, and website plus core technologies like HTML, HTTP, and URLs. Fill in the blanks. QUESTION 3 What did India’s Department of Atomic Energy present to CERN in 2004? It was

selected to commemorate the Indian government’s association with the organisation. QUESTION 4 Of the 12 founding members of CERN, 11 remain. Name the country that ceded its membership in 1961. Its government said the country’s high-energy physics programme was too limited to benefit substantially from CERN. QUESTION 5 CERN runs a distributed computing project called _____. Here, people can donate spare processing power on their personal computers over the internet, which a bespoke network makes use of to help perform calculations required by the Large Hadron Collider experiments.



Visual question: Name this instrument, which is the largest particle collider on the Large Hadron Collider at CERN. It is 46 m long, 25 m high and 25 m wide, and weighs around 7,000 tonnes. MAXIMILIEN BRICE/CERN

Questions and answers to the previous day’s daily quiz: 1. Her birth name. Ans: Hema 2. Significance of the song Paa Lagoon Kar Jori. Ans: It was her first recorded Hindi solo 3. The music director who backed her, after she was rejected for a having a ‘thin voice’. Ans: Ghulam Haider 4. Common element to the songs: Beeti Na Bitai Raina, Rootho Rootho Piya and Yaara Seeli Seeli (Lekin)? Ans: She won the National Awards for these songs 5. She composed music for Marathi films in the 1960s under this name. Ans: Anandghan 6. The rendition that brought PM Jawaharlal Nehru to tears in 1963. Ans: Aye Mere Watan Ke Logon 7. The music for the thumri Kanha Main Tose Hari was composed by this director. Ans: Satyajit Ray 8. She was awarded the Bharat Ratna in this year. Ans: 2001 Visual: The location of this installation. Ans: Ayodhya Early birds: Piyali Tuli| Erfanally Oosmany| Prem Nath Tiwari| Sukdev Shet| Gursharan Lal Vadhera Correction: The quoted song in question 7 of the quiz was not sung by Lata Mangeshkar.

Please send in your answers to
dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

Word of the day

Bemusement: confusion resulting from failure to understand
Synonyms: puzzlement, befuddlement

Usage: He shook his head in bemusement at the child’s unusual question.

Pronunciation: newsth.live/bemusement

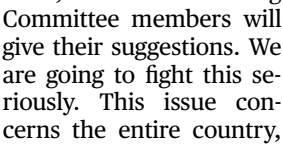
International Phonetic Alphabet: /bəˈmjuːzmənt/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to letters@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Text & Context’

He sought to restore in the electoral roll the names of electors who had preferred appeals against their deletion before the Appellate Tribunals in West Bengal. Of the 22 lakh applications filed by deleted electors in West Bengal, only 1,607 electors had been reinstated in time to vote in April.

Gyanesh Kumar must step down, says Congress chief

"The Election Commission's own people have exposed them," Mr. Kharge told presspersons, referring to concerns raised by

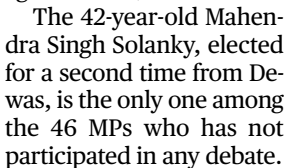


“The Election Commission is compromised and the Chief Election Commissioner is acting like a dictator. Without consulting his colleagues, Election Com-

The Opposition Indian National Democratic, Inclusive Alliance is scheduled to meet on Wednesday to work out a joint strategy, and is likely to consider moving another removal notice against Mr. Kumar in Parliament.

SC, ST MPs from BJP took part in fewer debates in LS than party peers: data

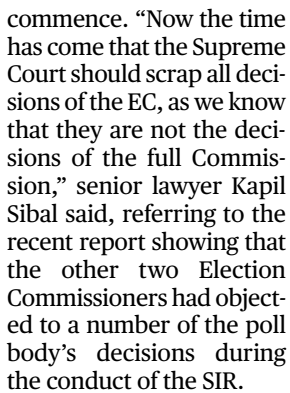
Party colleagues from other seats did more. The 145 BJP MPs outside SC and ST seats averaged 19.68.



He said BJP Lok Sabha MP Gajendra Singh Patel, who represents Khargone, a reserved tribal constituency in Madhya Pradesh, had pointed out that MPs from SC/ST communities were not being given adequate time to speak during discussions on important Bills. Mr. Manjhi urged the Speaker to take steps to rectify the situation.

Civil society groups seek SIR rollback, say polls must use previous voter list

They also demanded the immediate resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, failing which proceedings to remove him should

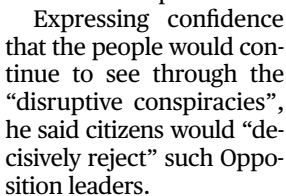


The activists also demanded a public social audit of the electoral roll as provided for in the Manual on Electoral Rolls issued in December 2023. “No voter must be removed without an open and public verification process at the level of gram sabha/ward sabha/

They asked for every SIR-related document to be placed in the public domain, and also demanded restoration of welfare benefits to those who were wrongfully denied them because their names were deleted from the revised electoral rolls.

Opposition is harbouring a 'toolkit mentality', says BJP

He accused them of attempting to defame constitutional institutions and derail India's progress towards a Viksit Bharat. He said "their political strategy relies on fabricating fal-



“Lacking both policy and vision, they are now devising new conspiracies to spread confusion and disorder in the country. A few days ago, a completely fabricated story was used to create turmoil across the nation. Now, when all the members of the Election Commission have exposed each and every one of their false allegations, they have once again begun making fresh attempts to vitiate the atmosphere,” the BJP leader alleged.

Ashamed to be part of Bihar govt., says Chirag

Referring to the recent cases of molestation of minor girls in Jamui, Samastipur, Banka, and other districts, Mr. Paswan said these incidents brought shame to Bihar. Mr. Paswan said the government should set such a precedent that "the hands of criminals should shake" before committing any crime against girls.

SC gives EC three months to settle Trinamool dispute

The Supreme Court directed the Election Commission of India (EC) on Monday to decide the leadership dispute between former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, and Ritabrata Banerjee, who leads a rival camp of Trinamool Congress legislators, in three months, after the parties complete their pleadings.

A three-judge Bench headed by the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant gave the rival factions four weeks from September 28 to file any additional responses, affidavits, counter-affidavits and other plead-

“In case of extreme exigencies, come before us,” Justice Joymalya Bagchi addressed Mr. Naidu.

Decide disqualification petitions against MLAs by Oct. 8, SC tells Bengal Speaker

The Supreme Court on Monday told the West Bengal Legislative Assembly Speaker to conclude by October 8 the disqualification proceedings initiated by former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee's Trinamool Congress faction against the rival Ritabrata Banerjee faction under the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution for alleged defection.

Appearing before a Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, senior advocates Kapil Sibal, Vivek Tankha and advocate Preetika Dwivedi, for the Mamata camp, said the top court had held in the *Keisham Meghachandra Singh versus Speaker, Manipur Legislative Assembly* judgment that the Speaker, acting as a Tribunal under the anti-defection law of the Tenth Schedule of Constitution, must decide dis-

“The three months expire on October 8. This has become a pattern. The Speaker does not deal with the disqualification petitions. The rebel MLAs go to the Election Commission (EC) and get an interim order,” Mr. Sibal submitted.

Mr. Sibal said the court must examine this "pattern" or it would create "political havoc".

"...I feel ashamed when I think about the fact that I am part of a government under which such incidents are taking place. This is a matter of concern," he added. After the BJP and Janata Dal (United), the LJP (RV) is the third-largest constituent of the Samrat Choudhary-led NDA government in Bihar, with 19 MLAs. It also has five MPs.



MAHA TRANSOCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

SRM E-Tender Notice (2nd Call)

Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Company Ltd, EHV PC O&M Zone Vashi invites bids through SRM e-Tender in two bid system (Techno-commercial Bid & Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for following works;

RFx No./ Tender No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost
7000041507 T-12/2026-27	Augmentation of substation by addition of 50MVA, 220/22kV PTR along with 1X 220kV GIS bay and 22kV GIS Consisting 6X 22kV feeder bay, 1X 22kV Incoming Bay, 1X 22kV PT bay, 1X 22kV Bus Coupler bay & interconnector bay along with allied Civil works at 220/22kV Kamba Substation under EHV (O&M) Division, Kalwa Vashi Zone (Transformer will be supplied by MSETCL).	Rs 1577.41 Lakhs excluding GST Rs 1861.35 Lakhs including GST

E.M.D. in Rs. 15,77,415/-, **Tender Fees:** Rs. 29,500/- including GST, **Sale period:** 28.09.2026 to 08.10.2026, **Last Date of Submission:** 08.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs., **Date of opening (Tech. bid):** 08.10.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. (if possible). **Contract person:** Executive Engineer, EHV PC O&M Zone, Vashi. Phone No. (022) 27660010 (P) / 27665994. For further details please visit to <https://srmetender.mahatransoco.in>

Sd/-
Chief Engineer
EHV PC (O&M) Zone, MSETCL, Vashi

Business

INBRIEF



UAE signals another \$25 bn investment in India: Goyal

The UAE has indicated its intent to invest an additional \$25 billion in India in the near future, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal said on Monday, as the two countries agreed to deepen cooperation across ports, shipbuilding, energy security, space technology and financial services. Speaking after co-chairing the 14th India-UAE High-Level Joint Task Force on Investments with Abu Dhabi Investment Authority MD Sheikh Hamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Mr. Goyal said the UAE has already invested around \$25 billion in India and has a longer-term objective of taking its investments in the country to \$100 billion. The discussions at the task force meeting covered investments, trade facilitation, taxation, logistics, energy, market access and financial cooperation, including use of local currency for bilateral trade.

NMDC commissions 2 MTPA pellet plant in Nagarnar

NMDC has commissioned a 2 million tonne per annum pellet plant in Nagarnar, Chhattisgarh, as part of a ₹5,427-crore integrated iron ore processing, pipeline and pellet making project connecting its iron ore operations in Bachelhi with the company’s steel plant in Nagarnar. The project includes a new iron ore processing plant in Bachelhi, a 15 MTPA slurry pipeline besides the 2 MTPA pellet plant. The 135 km slurry pipeline carries processed iron ore concentrate from Bachelhi to Nagarnar, providing an alternative to transporting the material by road, the company said on Sunday. The slurry pipeline passes through 61 villages in Bastar and Dantewada districts and is designed to reduce the movement of processed ore by road, provide alternate mode of evacuation and lower dependency on railways and ensures a dedicated link between Bachelhi operations and Nagarnar, NMDC said.

Tewolde’s flight plan: cost saving, deeper AI-AI Express synergies

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI



Tewolde Gebremariam

Cost cutting and deeper integration between Air India (AI) and low-cost arm Air India Express (AI Express) will be at the centre of CEO-designate Tewolde Gebremariam’s agenda, with the new AI chief calling for shared services, greater asset utilisation and organisation-wide focus on cutting duplication and improving efficiency. In his first town hall with staff, Mr. Gebremariam said AI and AI Express should operate as ‘multiple brands with a single unit of production,’ with the two airlines retaining distinct customer-facing identities while sharing resources wherever possible, sources said.

While AI will continue as a full-service carrier and AI Express as low-cost carrier, he said customer-facing functions would remain distinct while areas such as IT, HRD, finance and engineering could be streamlined and shared. “The objective would be to reduce costs and streng-

then the airlines’ competitiveness,” he said. Whether the two airlines ultimately operate with one Air Operator Certificate (AOC) or retain two was “secondary” to achieving operational synergies. “Cost saving is top on the agenda,” he said, urging staff to identify and propose cost-saving opportunities and help build a stronger culture of cost consciousness.

“No burning cash” He also linked cost agenda with the wider financial challenge, saying, “We cannot continue to lose money. We cannot continue to burn cash.” On revenue, he called for an urgent improvement in revenue/available seat

kilometre (RASK) and greater use of cargo as a revenue stream, saying AI was losing to foreign freighters. Safety and reliability, meanwhile, stay core priorities, with Mr. Gebremariam calling for consistent operational performance, including clean and safe aircraft, on-time departures and arrivals, baggage travelling with passengers and better disruption recovery. He also described growth as ‘the oxygen of business’ while stressing it must be profitable and sustainable. The CEO further called for a “One Air India” approach, a leaner and flatter organisation, fewer silos and reviews of outsourcing, IT systems and internal processes.

SEBI clears Vinod Adani of charges in shareholding case

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI



SEBI said the role played by Vinod Adani was advisory.

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) cleared Vinod Adani, elder brother of Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani, of allegations relating to the violation of minimum public shareholding (MPS) norms and Prohibition of Fraudulent and Unfair Trade Practices (PFUTP) regulations. In its final order, SEBI said the “foundational allegations” of effective control by Vinod Adani over two foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) and Opal Investment Pvt. Ltd. were not established. Consequently, the regulator did not uphold the allegation the

MPS norms of listed Adani Group firms were violated. The case involved allegations against 30 noticees, including individuals, foreign investment funds and Adani Group entities. The primary charge was Mr. Vinod Adani exercised control over investments made by two FPIs –

Excel Investment and Global Opportunities Management Ltd (GMAML) – in three Adani Group firms: Adani Enterprises, Adani Power and Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone. The allegation was this investment was in violation of SEBI regulations, which do not allow promoters to hold more than 25% in listed entities. Rejecting the charge, SEBI said the role played by Vinod Adani in relation to the two FPIs was advisory in nature and based on non-binding pacts. Separately, SEBI settled alleged MPS violations involving 18 noticees named in the order. The settlement included Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani.

India has over 80 days of fuel reserve, says Minister Puri

Saptaparno Ghosh
KOLKATA

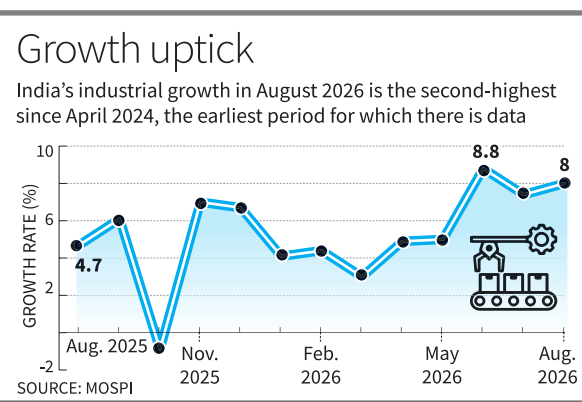
India has more than 80 days of fuel reserves, said Hardeep Singh Puri, Union Petroleum Minister at an event here. “The number of refineries has grown, import terminals have grown and I am sometimes asked why isn’t the country’s SPR bigger?” he stated, adding, “Please combine everything, we have more than eighty plus days [worth] of capacity to store,” the Minister added. (The reporter is in Kolkata at the invitation of the Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas)

Industrial growth quickens to 8% in Aug.

The growth in August is the second-highest for the period going back to April 2024, for which the new series of the IIP has data

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Industrial growth in India quickened to 8% in August 2026 from 7.35% a month earlier, driven by a strong performance in the manufacturing, electricity, capital goods, and consumer goods sectors. Growth in the Index of Industrial Production, data on which was released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation on Monday, was last quicker in June 2026 when it touched 8.8%. The growth in August is the second-highest for the period going back to April 2024 for which the new series of the IIP has data. “This [August growth] was aided by sharp growth in capital goods, intermediate, infrastructure, and consumer durable goods,” Madan Sabnavis, chief economist at the Bank of Baroda said. “For the five



months period, growth was at 6.7%,” Mr. Sabnavis added. “If this is maintained, India can register growth of 7-8% for the year on the back of higher growth during the festival season with demand building up. This makes the third quarter very critical for industry.” The manufacturing sector grew at 8.95% in August 2026, the second-highest in the history of the new series of the IIP after the 9.5% seen in June 2026. A deeper look showed that the

growth in the sector was driven by motor vehicles, electric and non-electric machinery, electronics, textiles, beverages, rubber, and non-metallic products. The electricity sector saw growth quicken to a 27-month-high of 12.3% in August 2026, which, according to Mr. Sabnavis, was supported by growth in both conventional and renewable electricity. The capital goods sector grew by 16.9%, which was however a three-month low.

West Asia worries send benchmark indices to six-month low

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Indian equity markets came under renewed selling pressure on Monday as escalating uncertainty over the West Asia conflict weighed on investor sentiment after the U.S. rejected

proposals for a ceasefire. The benchmark Sensex fell 1.52% to close at 72,771.72 points, while the Nifty50 declined 1.6% to settle at 22,780.25, extending losses from the previous session. The indices opened nearly 100 points below

their previous closes and slipped further during morning trade, with the Sensex briefly nearing the 72,000 mark and the Nifty approaching 22,000 levels by around 10:30 am. The benchmarks remained largely range-bound near the day’s lows before closing

lower. Monday’s decline marked the second instance in the past five trading sessions and the third in the last ten sessions when the benchmark indices fell more than 1%, highlighting renewed weakness after a prolonged phase of range-

bound movement. Selling pressure was broad-based, with all 21 sectoral indices on the NSE ending in the red. The Nifty Bank index declined nearly 2%, reflecting pressure across financial stocks. Of the 3,676 stocks traded on the NSE, more than 2,700 ended lower, while only around 896 stocks advanced, signalling a broad negative sentiment. Market participants attributed the sharp decline to concerns that the rejection of a ceasefire proposal by the U.S. could prolong tensions in West Asia.

Indian Overseas Bank
Information Technology Department
Central Office: 763, ANNA SALAI, CHENNAI-600002
Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:
GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL - TECHNOLOGY UPGRADEMENT OF TRENDMICRO INTRUSION PREVENTION SYSTEM (IPS) SOLUTION.
BID NO: GEM/2026/B/8074775 DATED 23.09.2026
The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

KSEB KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE
Office of the Chief Engineer (Commercial & Tariff), Vidyuthi Bhavanam, Thiruvananthapuram
Inviting Long term Power procurement of 500 MW RTC Power (Coal linkage under B(IV) of SHAKTI Policy), through e-bidding portal (DEEP) only
DEEP portal e -Tender No – KSEBL/Long/Coal from CL/26-27/ET/RFQ/75 & KSEBL/Long/Coal from CL/26-27/ET/RFQ/76 dt 23.09.2026.
Last Date for submission of queries - 17.10.2026
Submission of the Request for Proposal (RFP) through the DEEP Portal – 29.12.2026.
For more details visit www.kseb.in Ref: PR/MCI/F-402 /2026

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, R.S.A.M.B., DIVISION BIKANER
Rajakir Ref No. :- 24702245 Date :- 25/09/2026
NOTICE INVITING BID- 08/2026-27
Bids for Link Roads under KUMS Nokha, Bikaner (Grain), Pugal Road Grain Bikaner, Sridungargah and Repair Works of Office Building, KUMS Bikaner F&V amounting from Rs. 15.50 to 508.37 Lakhs are invited from eligible interested bidders upto dated 14.10.2026/26.10.2026, 06:00 PM. Other particulars of the bids may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) and RSAMB website <http://agriculture.rajjasthan.gov.in/rsamb> for detailed NIB.
UBN: AGM2627WSOB08066 to 870
Raj.Samwad/C/26/10860 RVUN/PR-4476 Superintending Engineer (TD-III)

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LIMITED
CIN:- U40102RJ2000SGC015484 (A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking)
C/o SE(TD-III), 604, Investment Building, Lal Kotah, Tonk Road, Jaipur
E-TENDER NOTICE
Online tenders are invited for TN-38(RVU2627GLOB013115) Procurement of MILD STEEL/ CARBON STEEL ITEMS INCLUDING PLATE, ANGLE, CHANNEL AND BEAM etc. FOR VARIOUS RVUN POWER STATIONS & 39(RVU2627GLOB013111) Procurement of SS items including plate, bar items etc. FOR VARIOUS RVUN POWER STATIONS. Tender details are available on <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> (for e-tender), www.energy.rajjasthan.gov.in/rvun1 & www.sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in.
Raj.Samwad/C/26/10860 RVUN/PR-4476 Superintending Engineer (TD-III)

कार्यालय नगर परिषद बून्दी
क्रमांक:- 7032 दिनांक:- 24.09.2026
:-: Corrigendum :-:
नगर परिषद बून्दी द्वारा जारी निविदा सं: न/07090/निर्माण/ 2026-27 / 5456 दिनांक 10 / 08 / 2026 की निविदा दिनांक 17 / 08 / 2026 से दिनांक 02 / 09 / 2026 06.00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन विक्रय की जाती थी। निविदा दिनांक 08 / 09 / 2026 को 04.00 बजे ऑनलाइन खोली जाती थी। उक्त निविदा में संशोधन करते हुए निविदा दिनांक 21.10.2026 को 6.00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन विक्रय की जावेगी। उक्त कार्य की BG (Bank Guarantee) दिनांक 22.10.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे दिनांक 23.10.2026 को 6.00 बजे तक जमा कराई जा सकती है। निविदा दिनांक 28.10.2026 को 4.00 बजे ऑनलाइन खोली जावेगी। विस्तृत शर्त व विवरण निविदा sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in/eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in पर DLB2627WLOB18533 (Tender ID 2026_DLB_588804_1) तथा कार्यालय समय में किसी भी कार्यदिवस को नगर परिषद में देखा जा सकता है।
आयुक्त नगर परिषद, बून्दी
राज.संवाद / सी / 26 / 10792

ANDHRA PRADESH POWER COORDINATION COMMITTEE
VIDYUTH SQUADHA - VIJAYAWADA
TENDER NOTICE
APPCO on behalf of the APDISCOMs inviting bids in single stage, two enveloped followed by e-RA through Bharat Electronic e-Tendering Portal vide Tender No: APCC/BESS-01/2026-27 for Procurement of 1,000 MW / 4,000 MWh (4-hour) storage capacity from fully commissioned Standalone BESS projects located anywhere in India through a tariff-based competitive bidding process, on-demand utilization by APDISCOMs, for a period of 2 years extendable for another period of 2 years with input power from APDISCOMs. The Interested and eligible applicants may participate in the bidding process through the ISN-ETS (Bharat Electronic e-Tendering) Portal and the Bid documents are available after 29.09.2026 at 19:00 hrs. The due date for submission of bids is 14.10.2026. For complete details and tender access visit: <https://www.bharat-electronictendering.com> Ph: 9493120085.
Sd/- Chief General Manager/APPC Power Purchase & Legal
R.O.NO.GMCC/APTRANSCO/159/26-27

APPOINTMENT
Indian Overseas Bank
Central Office, 763, Anna Salai, Chennai – 600002
ENGAGEMENT OF ADVISOR – CUSTOMER SERVICE ON CONTRACT BASIS
Indian Overseas Bank, a leading Public Sector Bank with headquarters in Chennai having geographical presence all over India and abroad, invites applications from eligible candidates retired from Public Sector Banks for the captioned recruitment process. The detailed advertisement regarding eligibility such as Age, Qualification, Experience & Other requirements are available in the Bank's website www.iob.bank.in under "Careers" page. APPLY ONLINE.
Online Registration: 29.09.2026 – 09.10.2026 (Both days inclusive)

KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(CIN:U40109KA1999SGC025521)
No. CEE/T&P/SEE-1/2026-27/6887-902 Date:28.09.2026
BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only)
KPTCL Invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry numbers on Partial Turnkey basis.
Sl. No. Enquiry Nos. and Name of the works
1 KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4234 Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at KHB Irubanhalli (Halalu) with associated 66kV LILO line for a distance of 0.235km in Nagamangala Taluk, Mandya District.
2 KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4240 Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at Beerihundi (K. Hemmanahally) with associated 66kV LILO line for a distance of 6.376kms in Mysuru Taluk & District.
3 KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4239 Establishing 2x31.5MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at Singanayakanahalli (Madappanahalli) along with running of 66kV 1000sqmm UG Cable from existing 220/66/11kV Puttenahalli (Yelahanka) sub-station to the proposed 66/11kV Singanayakanahalli (Madappanahalli) sub-station for a distance of 6.35kms & Modification of 66kV Terminal Bay at existing 220/66/11kV Puttenahalli (Yelahanka) sub-station in Bengaluru North Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District.

The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website <https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in> with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> on or after 01.10.2026 @ 15:00hrs. Last date & time for receipt of Bids and any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the KPP portal. Any details required in this regard can also be obtained from the office of the undersigned during office hours.
All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.
Sd/- Chief Engineer,(Electy),
Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL, 9th Floor,
Indhana Bhavan, A. R. Circle, Bengaluru-560 009.

KYAUKTAW

33 killed in military air strike in Myanmar's Rakhine: rebel group



A military air strike on a market in the town of Kyauktaw in Myanmar's Rakhine State killed 33 people on Monday and wounded 36 more, according to Arakan Army, the rebel faction which controls the area. Nearly half-a-million people are living displaced in the State due to the civil war unleashed by a 2021 military coup. AFP

FAIRFORD

Iran denies link to alleged bomb plot at U.S.-operated airbase in U.K.



Iran on Monday denied involvement in a suspected bomb plot at U.K.'s Royal Air Force Fairford base used by the U.S., as police said five men arrested nearby were all London-based Britons. Tehran's denial, issued via its embassy in London, followed widespread U.K. media reports that police were probing possible Iranian links. AFP

JERUSALEM

Netanyahu met UAE President in unannounced trip: Israeli media



Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu had made an unannounced trip to the UAE to meet President Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Israeli media reported on Sunday. The visit follows reports that the Emirati leader warned Mr. Netanyahu ahead of Hamas's October 7 attack, but the Israeli premier failed to inform security services. AFP

WASHINGTON

Trump offered to sell weapons to China during Xi visit: U.S. envoy



U.S. President Donald Trump offered to sell arms to his Chinese counterpart Xi Jinping in response to concern over weapons sales to Taiwan. "President Trump said, 'Hey, we sell arms to people around the world.' He actually asked President Xi would he like to buy some?" U.S. Ambassador to China David Perdue told Fox News. AFP

U.S. will be forced out, says Mojtaba as mediators work to broker a deal

Iran's Supreme Leader says 'enemy forces suffered painful blows' in first remarks since Trump rejected Tehran's proposal; Qatari mediators are expected to hold separate discussions with Iranian Minister Araghchi in New York and the U.S. side

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran's Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei said on Monday the United States would be forced to leave West Asia after suffering "painful blows", according to a statement carried by state television.

Mr. Khamenei made the remarks despite attempts to revive talks aimed at ending the fighting.

"Today, having suffered painful blows at the hands of valiant fighters and the guardians of the Strait of Hormuz, they (the enemies) do not venture beyond the Arabian Sea," Mr. Khamenei said in the



Tehran transit: Commuters drive past a portrait of Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei at Baharestan Square in Iran's capital. AFP

written statement attributed to him, without explicitly mentioning the U.S.

"Whenever they have braved this risk, they have only brought harm upon themselves. It will not be long before the Arabian

Sea, too, would rid itself of their presence," he added.

Iran and the U.S. have been vying for control over Hormuz since the war started with U.S.-Israeli strikes on Iran in February. Before the war began, the

strategic shipping route carried about a fifth of the world's oil and gas.

Meanwhile, Qatari mediators are expected to hold separate talks with Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi in New York and with the U.S. side on Monday or Tuesday, an official briefed on the negotiations said.

Iran's semi-official ISNA news agency also confirmed that Mr. Araghchi would meet the mediators.

Seven-day proposal

The talks are expected to focus on an amended version of a seven-day proposal that Iran presented last week on the sidelines of the the UN General As-

sembly. Iran's plan envisages ending all hostilities in Iran and Lebanon, unfreezing of its foreign assets, lifting sanctions on its oil sector, and an end to the U.S. naval blockade. Tehran would then reopen Hormuz, and the two sides would resume talks on Iran's nuclear programme.

U.S. President Donald Trump said on Saturday he had rejected Iran's proposal, saying Tehran wanted a swift agreement because of the crippling economic pressure it is under. However, he also told Axios on Sunday that he expected U.S. negotiators to engage in further talks this week.

(With inputs from Reuters)

Pope urges Europeans to welcome migrants as family

Sriram Lakshman
LONDON

Pope Leo XIV called for a more welcoming attitude towards migrants in Europe as he concluded a four-day visit to France.

Speaking in Metz, once the home of Robert Schuman, one of the European Union's founding fathers and a proponent of reconciliation after the Second World War, the Pope criticised calls by leaders to increase arms expenditure, saying it was contrary to the process of peace through dialogue.

The head of the Catholic Church was accompanied to Metz by French President Emmanuel Macron.

"We see many men and women fleeing war and persecution," the Pope said, citing the case of the Canary Islands, which has



Pope Leo XIV

seen an influx of migrants from Africa.

"We need to welcome people. We need to integrate them as a member of our own family, giving them the possibility to develop their skills and live according to their values," he added.

In an apparent nod to the EU's official policies, the Pope acknowledged the need to fight human trafficking and to imple-

ment policies that will allow people to live on their own lands. He also said that migrants needed to be taught the history of the lands they are joining, and he called for dialogue between different groups.

His remarks come as the far right in Europe is making surges. France's own nativist party, National Rally, won a record 14 seats in the Senate over the weekend, giving it the right to form a legislative caucus.

The Pope also made veiled references to his opposition to abortion and the assisted dying, asking people to "love life at every moment" and to "fight for life". Speaking on Sunday in Lourdes, the Pope had pushed back against abortion rights and French laws on assisted dying, calling the process "false compassion".

Seoul seeks apology from Ukraine in row over N. Korean POWs

Agence France-Presse
SEOUL

South Korea's presidential office has demanded an apology from Ukraine for denying an agreement to keep the transfer of two North Korean prisoners of war to Seoul confidential.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy disclosed last week that his country had sent two North Korean soldiers to the South, saying they were "not easy to capture alive".

Hours after Zelenskyy's remarks at the UN, South Korea's President Lee Jae Myung expressed his dismay. "I do not know why the Ukrainian side broke

the agreement and made the matter public, but it is very disappointing," he wrote on X.

Seoul said confidentiality was key to protect the POWs' relatives from repercussions in North Korea.

Mr. Zelenskyy's aide Dmytro Lytvyn sought to play down the disclosure, saying that the President did not share any personal details. But Seoul condemned what it viewed as a breach of trust, noting that Mr. Zelenskyy's press office had denied there was a confidentiality deal.

The dispute risks complicating Kyiv's efforts to obtain weapons from allies including South Korea to fight off Russian attacks.

Russia carries out drone strikes across Ukraine; seven killed

Associated Press
KYIV

Russia's round-the-clock bombardment of targets in Ukraine killed at least seven people and wounded 80 more, officials said on Monday.

Moscow's forces pounded apartment blocks, data centres and a building of the National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine in Kyiv, among other targets.

Russian drone attacks on the Kyiv region killed four people, officials said.

A woman was killed in a Russian strike on Kyiv's Shevchenkivskiy district. The strike hit the National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine, the latest cultural

landmark in the capital to be damaged.

One drone struck an office centre in central Dnipro, killing three people, local authorities said.

Russia's Defense Ministry said its forces struck two data centres as well as several gas stations in Kyiv, a distribution hub belonging to the Nova Poshta postal service in Odesa, a cargo ship in the Black Sea and another one in the port of Chornomorsk.

'Gains in Donetsk'

Meanwhile, Ukraine's Third Army Corps said on Monday it had recaptured 51 square kilometres from the Russians in the Donetsk region.

U.S., China unveil list of 'non-sensitive' products under \$30 billion tariff cut

Associated Press
HONG KONG

The U.S. and China on Monday released reciprocal lists of non-sensitive products worth about \$30 billion each that will see tariff cuts, in a deal expected to help bolster bilateral trade.

The details came days after Chinese President Xi Jinping met with U.S. President Donald Trump in Washington in his first state visit to the U.S. since 2015.

China's Commerce Ministry said in a statement the agreement will help strengthen trade cooperation.

The lists included 1,619 items of U.S. goods enter-



Trade diplomacy: The details come days after Chinese President Xi Jinping met with U.S. President Donald Trump in Washington. AFP

ing China, ranging from agricultural items (excluding soybeans), hair and personal care products to timber and medical equipment. Coal from the U.S. will also be included.

For Chinese goods exported to the U.S., 77 cate-

gories were covered, including fireworks, tableware, toys like dolls and puzzles, glass and wooden Christmas ornaments and soccer balls.

Tariff rates on over 90% of the products would be subject to "most-favoured-

nation" levels, the Chinese Ministry said, meaning that country-specific tariffs will effectively be eliminated.

U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said the product lists focused on "non-sensitive goods on each side that could benefit from more favourable tariff treatment." The deal could help secure market access for U.S. farmers, manufacturers, businesses and workers, while benefiting American consumers with imports from China including household goods and toys, Mr. Greer said.

Sectors of strategic importance, such as chips, electric vehicles and batteries, were not covered under the agreement.

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NOTICE INVITING TENDER NO. 11 Dated: 28.09.2026

Tenders (Pre-qualification and / or commercial offers) through e-procurement portal (<http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>) are invited for supply of the following Goods/Services.

Tender Nos as per e-Portal	Nomenclature of Items/ Services/Equipment	Tender value In Crores (Approx.)	Last date for submission of tender @17.00 hrs.
KSRTC/2026-27/ SE4119	Selection of system Integrator(Si) for the implementation of smart ticketing system for STUs of Karnataka.	370.00	29.10.2026
KSRTC/2026-27/ SE4123	Selection of third party Audit agency for managing the transactions & providing web based application with end to end online process for KSRTC Health Scheme.	0.50	15.10.2026
KSRTC/2026-27/ IND0347	Procurement of Radiator Assemblies & Cores.	5.25	29.10.2026
KSRTC/2026-27/ IND0348	Procurement of Industrial Gases (Dissolved Acetylene, CO2, O2 & Commercial Argon)	1.00	29.10.2026

NOTE:- Interested suppliers need to register in the e-procurement portal. For further information log into <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>. In case of further assistance, contact e-procurement cell (**Phone. No. 080-46010000/080-68948777**). Interested bidders may also contact e-procurement cell for training on bid submission. Mail to Support@eprochelpdesk.com for further information if required. In case of bidders need assistance from KSRTC, can communicate at cosp@ksrtc.org, (contact: 7760990224)

Sd/
CONTROLLER OF STORES & PURCHASES
(Tender Inviting Authority)

DIPRI/CP/2978/MAA/2026-27

राजस्थान आवासन मण्डल
क्रमांक :- 318 दिनांक :- 28 / 09 / 2026

रुचि की अभिव्यक्ति (EOI)

स्थानीय निवासियों को बेहतर सुव्यवस्थित एवं वहनीय सामुदायिक सुविधाएं उपलब्ध कराने के उद्देश्य से राजस्थान आवासन मण्डल द्वारा कुड़ी भगतसनी आवासीय योजना, जोधपुर के सेक्टर-3, 4 जोधपुर एवं 8 स्थित सामुदायिक भवनों को पृथक-पृथक 5 वर्ष की सीमित अवधि हेतु संचालन एवं रख-रखाव अनुबंध (Agreement for Operation & Maintenance - O&M) के आधार पर दिए जाने के लिए इच्छुक पात्र फर्म / संस्थाओं से प्रस्ताव आमंत्रित किए जाते हैं।

चयन खुली प्रतिस्पर्धात्मक प्रक्रिया में उच्चतम पात्र वित्तीय प्रस्ताव के आधार पर किया जाएगा। स्वीकृत मासिक संचालन एवं रख-रखाव शुल्क में प्रतिवर्ष 5 प्रतिशत वृद्धि, तीन माह की ब्याज-मुक्त सुरक्षा जमा, उध-पट्टा/हस्तांतरण निशेध, परिसर का रख-रखाव एवं मूल्य संवर्धन, नियमानुसार पार्किंग एवं वैधानिक अनुपालन तथा स्थानीय निवासियों एवं आमजन की सामुदायिक सुविधा तक निर्बाध पहुंच प्रमुख शर्तें होंगी। स्वीकृत दर सूची परिसर में प्रमुख स्थान पर प्रदर्शित की जाएगी। भूमि एवं भवन का स्वामित्व एवं निरंतरण राजस्थान आवासन मण्डल में ही निहित रहेगा।

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e-TENDER NOTICE
NIT. No. TIDCO/DFH-Coimbatore/2026-27 Date:29.09.2026

TIDCO invites bids from the eligible bidders through e-Tender for the work mentioned below:

S.No	Particulars	EMD Amount in Rs.
1.	e-Tender for Selection of Consultant for Preparation of Techno-Economic Feasibility Report for Establishment of Digital FinTech Hub at Coimbatore.	3,00,000/-

Tenders shall be uploaded through <https://tntenders.gov.in> on or before **3.00 PM on 29.10.2026** and the same will be opened on **29.10.2026 at 5.00 PM.**

For More details, please visit <https://tntenders.gov.in>

DIPRI/2957/TENDER/2026

Chairman and Managing Director
TIDCO

OFFICE OF EXECUTIVE ENGINEER JAISINGHPUR DIVISION
H.P. PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, JAISINGHPUR -176095
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e-Procurement Notice
INVITATION FOR BID(IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Jaisinghpur Division, HPPWD, Jaisinghpur on behalf of the Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the online bids on percentage rate of following works from the eligible and approved Contactors/Firms registered with HPPWD Department:-

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost in Rs.	Earnest Money	Time Limit	Cost of tender form
1.	Restoration of rain damages on Trehla Badhala Dali Road Km 0/00 to 4/500 (SH-C/O 3.00 mtr. Span slab at RD 4/116, 5.00 mtr. Span at RD 3/981, CC Pavement from RD 2/200 to 2/350 and 2/600 to 2/665) PDNA 2025	7133071/-	142700/-	Three month	2000/-
2.	Restoration of rain Damages on Jaisinghpur to Vijapur road Km 0/00 to 2/00 (SH-C/O R/wall at Km 0/175 to 0/210 and 0/270 to 0/291) PDNA 2025	1147702/-	23000/-	Two month	500/-
3.	Restoration of rain damages on Trehla Badhala Dali Road Km 0/00 to 4/500 (SH-C/O 3.00 mtr. Span slab at RD 4/116, 5.00 mtr. Span at RD 3/981, CC Pavement from RD 2/200 to 2/350 and 2/600 to 2/665) PDNA 2025	810160/-	16300/-	Two month	350/-
4.	Restoration of rain Damages on Bhawana to Jhunga Devi road Km 15/500 to 26/250 (SH-C/O B/wall from RD 220/200 to 20/235) PDNA 2025	704113/-	14100/-	Two Month	350/-

Start date for downloading of bid : 01.10.26
Deadline for submission of Bid : 06.10.26

The bidders are advised to note other details / Terms & conditions of tenders from the departmental website <https://hptenders.gov.in>. The Executive Engineer reserves the right to reject any tender or all tenders without assigning any reasons.

Executive Engineer
Jaisinghpur Division,
H.P.PWD., Jaisinghpur.
(On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh)

HP / 3732/26-27 HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK.

BIG BOOST

Gulveer terms 1,500m silver as an important one in his career



R.V. MOORTHY

▲ This is a very important medal in my career. I have no problem in running as many events and I want to win medals in them. I could not maintain my final kick speed till the end as I am normally a long-distance runner — India's Gulveer Singh, *right in pic*, who clinched a silver in men's 1500m.

OVERCOMING HURDLES

Getting a personal best in tough conditions is satisfying: Yashvir



R.V. MOORTHY

▲ Indian javelin thrower Yashvir Singh expressed “satisfaction” at delivering his personal best in challenging conditions at the Asian Games in Nagoya. “The grip was slippery in the rain and it was difficult to find the rhythm or speed during run up. Getting a PB amidst all this is satisfying,” Yashvir said after his silver show.

MARQUEE CLASH

India drubs Bangladesh, meets Pakistan in men's hockey semifinal



AHF

▲ India blanked Bangladesh 10-0 in its final pool game of the men's hockey competition at the Asian Games on Monday. The defending champion topped Pool A with five wins from as many games. India plays Pakistan in the first semifinal on Thursday while Malaysia takes on South Korea in the other last-four clash on the same day.

BITTER ENDING

Kazakhstan race walker loses gold medal over footwear breach



REUTERS

▲ Kazakhstan's Yasmina Toxanbayeva suffered Asian Games heartbreak in Nagoya on Monday after her victory in women's marathon race walk was scrubbed out on a footwear technicality. Danzeng Quzong was elevated to the gold-medal spot in a China one-two with Ma Li while Japan's Yukiko Umeno was third.

Yashvir, Gulveer and Sreeshankar secure silver

Rohit makes it a double podium for India in javelin; Vithya breaks the National record en route her third-place finish in 400m hurdles; Parul bags a bronze for the second successive day

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

A National record was broken and some personal marks were bested at the Paloma Mizuho Athletics Stadium as the Indians added more medals to their kitty on Monday, of both hues except the golden one the country desperately craved.

Three years ago, Vithya Ramraj ran the 400m hurdles in 55.42 seconds, equalling the longest standing Indian track record held by the legendary P.T. Usha for 39 long years since 1984. It helped her top the group before eventually winning bronze in Hangzhou. On Monday, the 28-year-old won another bronze but this one was a lot more special – the 54.75 seconds finally made her the sole National record holder, in the presence of Usha, now the IOA president. Anu Raghavan, meanwhile, also ran an individual best 55.88 seconds to finish fifth.

If Vithya found herself in elite company, the javelin throw continued to be the country's reliable medal-earners with India managing a double podium finish. In Neeraj Chopra's absence, Rohit Yadav and Yashvir Singh were expected to shoulder the burden



Field day: Gulveer picked up his second silver in this edition. Sreeshankar took the second spot for the second straight Games. Parul earned another bronze while Yashvir and Rohit made it a 2-3 for India. R.V. MOORTHY

and both stepped up on the big stage.

Yashvir, in particular, justified his last-minute inclusion as Neeraj's replacement, throwing 85.72m for a personal best and silver. Yashvir went hard to match up to leader Ramesh Pathirage but the Sri Lankan world leader and

pre-tournament favourite dug deep in wet and challenging conditions for 88.55m in his final throw and won the gold. Rohit managed 84.35m for bronze.

Gulveer Singh, too, added a second silver to his tally here with a new personal mark of 3:36.72s in

the 1500m – after leading for more than 1.5 laps and looking set for the top spot before Kazuto Iizawa overtook him in the final 20m. Long jumper M. Sreeshankar, too, got his second silver in as many Games with an effort of 8.07m.

Unfortunately, the constant downpour meant the

track and the take-off board were extremely slippery and Sreeshankar's left leg slipped dangerously in his fourth attempt, the 27-year-old landing awkwardly on the pit and twisting his ankle. He skipped his last two attempts but the second jump was good enough to ensure him the

Medals table

	Country	G	S	B	T
1	China	132	53	45	230
2	Japan	41	68	63	172
3	South Korea	21	26	44	91
4	Uzbekistan	12	17	13	42
5	Kazakhstan	9	13	23	45
12	India	4	20	21	45

second spot behind China's Shi Yuhao's 8.17m.

India missed out on a podium for the first time in 32 years in women's discus throw.

Seema fourth

Seema Kaliramna's personal best of 59.88m fetched her only a fourth position. Seema, who had won bronze at the Commonwealth Games recently, was unable to emulate another Seema (Punia), a legend of the sport with five consecutive medals from 2006-2022.

The biggest upset, however, was defending champion and favourite Avinash Sable finishing fourth in 8:21.67s in the 3,000m steeplechase. It was only his second race this year and a far cry from the Games record of 8:19.50 last time around. Parul Chaudhary took home a second bronze in the 5,000m.



Pleased as punch: Vithya clinched the 400m hurdles bronze with a National record. R.V. MOORTHY

Vithya happy to go past Usha's mark

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

For close to four decades, P.T. Usha remained the undisputed queen of the Indian track, no one able to better her in clearing hurdles, both literally and figuratively. On a wet and humid Monday evening at the Asian Games, Vithya Ramraj finally rewrote the 400m hurdles National record and the 28-year-old couldn't have been happier, or Usha more proud.

She finished third with 54.75s but that was immaterial for someone who equalled Usha's record of 55.42 set at the 1984 Los Angeles Olympics in the last Asiad. She had been

trying to go past ever since. “I met Usha ma’am a year ago and she said, go for 54 seconds. She encouraged me. So doing this today makes me so happy. Everyone's been asking me for the past three years when I will do 55.4 seconds again, there was pressure,” she admitted.

The conditions were tricky and Vithya agreed things could have been even better. “Back home we never train in the rain for hurdles because there is always a concern about getting injured. Thankfully it stopped during the race but it was pouring during warm-up and I was only praying it to stop, if only for the race duration”.

Esha guns down silver

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Five consecutive shoot-offs and a silver to show for it at the end of a gruelling competition that witnessed drama, courage, confusion, controversy and heartbreak. India's shooting campaign at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games continued to give hope and despair, this time in the women's 25m pistol event on Monday.

Esha Singh, sneaking into the final as the eighth and final qualifier, kept her nerve till the last shot before succumbing to pressure and finishing second after being level with China's Xiao Jiaruixuan at the end of the regulation series. The two were tied on an Asian Games record equalling 38 points and entered the shoot-off, scoring identical fours. The second shoot-off saw Xiao score another four while Esha could manage only three.

Only one round earlier, Esha had held off North Korea's Kim Hyon Suk in three consecutive bronzemedal shoot-offs, after being tied on 34, to stay in contention for the gold. The 21-year-old reigning World No. 1 had earlier finished with 580 in the two-



Steely display: Esha showed plenty of fight to finish second. PTI

day qualifying – 290 each in precision and rapid – edging past Taiwan's Cheng Yen-Ching by virtue of more shots closer to the centre – 22 to Cheng's 20.

It was perhaps a fitting end to a day that saw India slip into fifth spot as team and Rahi Sarnobat, the most experienced member of the shooting contingent, missing a shot completely and hitting the target frame as per the judges to end any chance of advancing.

Rahi, who was 15th with a score of 287 after the precision round on day one on Sunday, shot an 86 in the first series of rapid on Monday. Her very first shot was adjudged as having hit the

frame, the Indians immediately filed an official protest but the result stood. It left her with no chance of making up in the remaining 29 shots and although the senior pro tried her best, scoring 99 and 96 in the remaining two rounds, she finished at 30th with a total of 568.

Manu Bhaker, meanwhile, finished her rapid series with a 99 but it wasn't enough for her to make the top-eight in the individual event, scoring 579. Rahi's missed shot also cost India a team medal. Third after the opening day, India eventually ended with a total of 1,727, just seven off third-placed Taiwan.

‘Confusion’: Rahi on technical issues

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Esha Singh won Asian Games silver in 25m pistol on Monday. While the youngster deservedly got the appreciation, the spotlight was taken by technical issues and scoring controversies involving Rahi Sarnobat that perhaps cost the Indian team a gold.

Rahi's first shot of the first series on the day was

declared on the frame, resulting in a zero.

“When you hit the frame, there is a different sound from when you hit the target. I didn't hear that and a few shooters from other countries also said they did not hear a different sound. Secondly, target 21 showed there was an extra shot but then showed an extra shot on target 20 as well. So, there was some confusion”.

INDIANS IN ACTION TODAY

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Tuesday (all times IST):

Athletics: Semifinals: Women's 65kg: Parveen vs Shu (Chn), 10.15 a.m.; Men's 80kg: Ankush vs. Erkinboev (Uzb), 11 a.m.; Men's +90kg: Narender vs. Oralbay (Kaz), 11.30 a.m.
Shooting: Trap individual qualification and team final (day 3, 6.30 a.m.): Men (Ahvar, Kynan, Shapath); Women (Manisha, Aashima, Neeru); Trap individual final: Women (10.30 a.m.); Men (noon).
Squash: Women's team (Pool C): vs. Iran, 6.30 a.m.
Tennis: Second round: Men: Dhakshineswar vs. Gunawan (Ina), 10 a.m.; Nagal vs. Hong (Kor), not before 12.30 p.m.; Doubles: Anirudh & Sriram Balaji vs. Abhishek & Pradip (Nep), not before 12.30 p.m.; Yuki & Dhakshineswar vs. Yevseyev & Zhukayev (Kaz), not before 12.30 p.m.; First round: Mixed doubles: Ankita & Sriram Balaji vs. Chong & Thompson (Hkg), not before 3.30 p.m.
Volleyball: Men (Pool C): vs. Qatar, 12.30 p.m.

Pincky wins bronze in kurash

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

She became the most successful Indian kurash athlete in the Asian Games with a bronze on Monday, but Pincky Balhara was sobbing at the end of her semifinal bout, not because she was overwhelmed by emotion but because a battered knee had denied her a better finish.

Pincky revealed that she was struck on the right knee during the quarterfinal win over Korea's Lim Garam. Taking on another Korean Sumin Mo in the last four of the -78kg category, Pincky said the hurting knee could not take the fresh onslaught and hampered her performance. “I was attacking but she was attacking me there again and again. I lost on penalty,” said Pincky, who won the silver in the -52kg section in Jakarta 2018.

Kurash is an Uzbek form of wrestling in which grapplers are not allowed to punch or kick their opponents or grab their legs.

The bouts are conducted in upright position and the competitors have to throw each other on their backs with full control and force to earn points.



Creditable effort: Pincky claimed her second Asiad medal. AP

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Monday:

Athletics: Men: Javelin throw final: Yashvir (silver), Rohit (bronze); Long jump final: Sreeshankar (silver), David (seventh); 1500m final: Gulveer (silver), Yoonus (ninth); 3000m steeplechase final: Sable (fourth); 400m hurdles final: Santhosh (seventh); 4x400m relay: First in heat 2, advanced to the final. Women: 400m hurdles final: Vithya (bronze), Anu (fifth); 5000m final: Parul (bronze), Seema (sixth); Discus throw final: Seema Kaliramna (fourth), Sanya (eighth); 4x100m relay final: Fourth; 800m: Pooja (fifth in heat 2 and seventh overall), qualified for the final, Gowthami (fourth in heat 1 and ninth overall), DNQ for final. 4x100m mixed relay: Second in heat 2, advanced to the final.
Boxing: Quarterfinals: Women's 75kg: Lovlina bt Seong (Kor); 60kg: Priya bt Samadova (Tjk); Men's 90kg: Kapil bt Kim (Kor).

Cricket: Men (quarterfinal): vs. Afghanistan (Match abandoned. India advanced by virtue of being the higher-seeded team).
Hockey: Men (Pool A): bt Bangladesh 10-0.
Kurash: Women -78kg (semifinal): Pincky lost to Sumin (Kor), bagged bronze.
Shooting: 25m pistol women individual final: Esha (silver); Team final: Fifth (Manu, Esha, Rahi); Trap individual qualification (day 2): Men: Shapath (fifth), Kynan (19th), Ahvar (32nd); Women: Neeru (first), Manisha (21st), Aashima (23rd).
Squash: Women's team (Pool C): bt China 2-1, bt Japan 2-1; Men's team (Pool A): bt China 3-0, bt South Korea 3-0.
Tennis: Women's doubles (first round): Ankita & Rutuja lost to Danilina & Putintseva (Kaz) 7-5, 3-6, [5-10].
Volleyball: Men (Pool C): bt Hong Kong 3-0.

WORLD HEART DAY

SEPTEMBER 29, 2026

ADVERTISEMENT



Dr. Akhilesh Shrivastava
Cardiologist

DIET IN HEART FAILURE

To manage heart failure, adopting a healthy diet is crucial. Here are some tips:

- Limit sodium intake to 2,000 mg per day to reduce water retention and alleviate symptoms.
- Be mindful of "hidden" salt in processed and prepared foods, and read food labels carefully.
- Limit alcohol and fluids as advised by your

physician.

- Opt for lean meats, poultry, and oily fish (like salmon) at least twice a week.
- Avoid processed and prepared foods high in sodium and unhealthy fats.
- Choose baked or steamed dishes over fried options when dining out.
- Use herbs, lemon juice, and spices to add flavor instead of salt.

HEART HEALTH AT EVERY AGE

Heart health begins long before old age. Children and young adults can develop habits that influence cardiovascular health for life. Regular movement, nutritious food, healthy sleep, and avoiding tobacco can establish a strong foundation early. As people grow older, monitoring blood pressure, cholesterol, blood glucose, weight, and other risk factors becomes increasingly important. Family history may also influence risk, making awareness especially valuable. Heart disease is not simply an older person's problem, and younger age does not make unhealthy habits harmless. The best approach is to build healthy routines before problems. This World Heart Day, families can make heart health a shared goal by walking together, preparing nutritious meals, and encouraging active lifestyles. Protecting the heart is a lifelong journey, and every age offers an opportunity to make healthier choices.



Dr. Amitabh Yaduvanshi
Cardiologist

MANAGING YOUR STRESS IN HEART FAILURE

Managing stress is crucial when living with heart failure. To reduce stress, try these tips:

- Avoid using food and alcohol as coping mechanisms
- Set boundaries and prioritize your own needs
- Don't smoke or use nicotine products
- Engage in regular exercise, such as a enjoyable activity with realistic

goals

- Practice good time management and set priorities
- Take time to relax and recover from stress
- Focus on what you can control and accept what

you can't

- Boost your self-esteem by acknowledging your strengths

Remember to talk to your doctor for more ideas on managing stress. By taking these steps, you can reduce stress and improve your overall well-being.



Dr. Ashish Jai Kishan
Cardiologist



Dr. Avinash Bansal
Cardiologist

UNDERSTANDING PERSON'S RISK FOR THE HEART FAILURE

Heart failure (HF) can limit daily activities and impact overall health, but research offers new hope and effective strategies. While the prevalence of HF is rising, many individuals with HF can lead full lives with proper treatment. The main causes and risk factors of HF include coronary artery disease, heart attack, and high blood pressure. Additional risk factors for HF are:

- Age: risk increases with advancing age
- Gender: men are at higher risk
- Family history and genetics
- Diabetes
- Obesity
- Lifestyle factors: smoking, sedentary lifestyle, and substance abuse
- Certain medications: anabolic steroids and some anti-cancer drugs

Understanding these risk factors can help individuals take proactive steps to reduce their likelihood of developing HF.



Dr. Gautam Sharma
Cardiologist

GENDER BIAS IN EMERGENCY CARE AFFECTS WOMEN'S OUTCOMES

Gender bias in emergency care affects women's outcomes after heart attacks, contributing to higher complication and death rates. Women presenting with heart attack symptoms are sometimes taken less seriously, leading to delayed tests, fewer treatments, and slower decision-making. Symptoms in women may appear atypical, but this should not reduce urgency. Unconscious assumptions about risk can influence how quickly care is provided. Training healthcare teams to recognize bias and follow standardized treatment protocols helps ensure women receive timely, evidence-based care. Patients should feel confident seeking emergency help and asking questions. Addressing bias improves fairness, safety, trust, and survival for women during cardiac emergencies.

HEART DISEASE REMAINS A LEADING CAUSE OF DEATH AMONG WOMEN

Heart disease remains one of the leading causes of death among women worldwide, yet awareness remains low. Many women believe cancer is their greatest health threat, while heart disease silently causes more deaths each year. This misunderstanding often leads women to ignore early warning signs such as chest discomfort, breathlessness, unusual fatigue, or nausea. Delayed medical attention can result in serious complications or death. Women are also less likely to receive timely diagnosis and treatment compared to men. Regular health checkups, awareness of symptoms, and early lifestyle changes can greatly reduce risk. Understanding that heart disease affects women of all ages is essential for prevention, early treatment, and long-term survival.



Dr. Heemanshu Lodhi
Cardiologist

PROCEDURES AND SURGERIES IN HEART FAILURE

Heart failure occurs when the heart struggles to pump blood effectively. It doesn't mean the heart has stopped working, but rather that it needs support to function better. Surgery and procedures can help correct underlying issues, but they don't cure heart failure. These



Dr. Mitendra Singh Yadav
Cardiologist

procedures include:

- Coronary stents to open blocked arteries
- Coronary bypass surgery (CABG) to bypass blocked areas
- Heart valve surgery to repair or replace faulty valves

While there's no cure for heart failure, available treatments can manage symptoms and improve quality of life. A physician will develop a management plan based on the diagnosed stage of heart failure. With proper treatment, individuals with heart failure can lead active and fulfilling lives.



Dr. N R Shastri
Cardiologist

HOW TO PREVENT CAREGIVER BURNOUT?

Caregiver burnout is a state of physical, emotional, and mental exhaustion that can occur when caregivers don't get the help they need. To prevent burnout, follow these steps:

- Find someone to talk to about your feelings
- Set realistic goals and acknowledge your limits
- Prioritize self-care, including healthy eating, exercise, and sleep
- Educate yourself about the illness and develop coping tools
- Accept your feelings, including frustration and anger
- Join a caregiver support group to share experiences and find resources

Remember, taking care of yourself is essential to providing effective care for your loved one. By prioritizing your own well-being, you can reduce stress and prevent burnout.



A Patient Awareness Initiative



Dr. Pawan Zutshi
Cardiologist

HEART FAILURE: COMMON QUESTIONS IN THE PERSON'S MIND

Heart failure occurs when the heart becomes too weak or stiff to pump blood effectively. Several factors contribute to heart failure, including:

- Coronary artery disease (CAD), which blocks blood supply to the heart
- High blood pressure, which strains the heart
- Damaged heart valves, which can be

repaired to improve heart function

To diagnose heart failure, doctors assess the heart's ejection fraction, which measures the percentage of blood pumped out by the left ventricle. A normal ejection fraction is 50-65%. Heart failure can be categorized into two types: systolic heart failure (HF-rEF) and diastolic heart failure (HF-pEF).

KNOW "WHY THE LUNGS ARE FILLED WITH THE FLUID IN HEART FAILURE"?

When someone has heart failure, their heart doesn't pump efficiently, causing fluid buildup in the body. This can lead to swollen ankles and, more severely, fluid in the lungs, which can be life-threatening. Medications for heart failure are crucial as they help alleviate symptoms, prevent fluid buildup, and improve breathing. Diuretics, or "water pills," play a key role in removing excess salt and fluid from the body. Warning signs of fluid buildup in the lungs include:

- Weight gain
- Increased swelling in the feet, ankles, or legs
- Increased tiredness or trouble breathing

Working with your doctor to create an action plan can help you recognize and respond to these warning signs, ensuring timely intervention and effective management of heart failure.



Dr. Sanjay Parmar
Cardiologist

WARNING SIGNS OF HEART FAILURE

Heart failure occurs when the heart muscle can't fill or pump blood effectively, unlike a heart attack, which is caused by blocked blood flow to the heart. If you experience any of the following symptoms, contact your doctor:

- Shortness of breath
- Dizziness or lightheadedness
- Sudden weight gain
- Swelling in legs, feet, hands, or abdomen
- Persistent cough or chest congestion
- Fatigue or decreased ability to perform daily activities
- Loss of appetite or nausea

Seek immediate medical attention if you experience:

- Chest pain lasting over 15 minutes
- Severe shortness of breath
- Fainting or passing out
- Irregular heartbeat or palpitations
- Pink or frothy sputum when coughing.



Dr. Siddhant Trehan
Cardiologist



Dr. Vikash Kataria
Cardiologist

INCREASE PHYSICAL ACTIVITY AND REDUCING STRESS IN HEART FAILURE

Managing heart failure requires a holistic approach. Here are some tips:

Physical Activity: Aim for 30 minutes of exercise per day, most days of the week. Break it into shorter segments, and incorporate activities like walking, cycling, or swimming. Consult your clinician before starting any new exercise routine.

Reducing Stress: Engage in stress-reducing activities like deep breathing, yoga, tai chi, or hobbies. Take time to relax and recharge.

Getting Support: Don't isolate yourself. Talk to your healthcare provider about support options, such as counseling or support groups. Stay connected with friends and family, and prioritize your mental and emotional well-being.

R. Kaushik

Fast bowling is a very physically demanding and unnatural activity that places immense strain on various different parts of the body. The most affected, one might say, are the back, the knees and the ankles, but the shoulder bears a heavy burden too, as does the heel and the shin.

Fast bowling calls for sheer bloody-mindedness, especially in a country like India where, until perhaps a decade back, the pitches offered absolutely no assistance even in domestic cricket. The diktat to leave a few millimetres of grass, interestingly during Sourav Ganguly's tenure as the BCCI president, has had a domino effect with the medium-pacers and those slightly quicker than that having a field day at the expense of spin. But even so, it requires a certain mindset to want to embrace fast bowling in the subcontinent - perhaps with the exception of Pakistan, who somehow seem to throw up quicks a dime a dozen.

It's not as if spin bowling is an easier endeavour. It would seem to be an unequal contest, fast bowlers thundering in from 20 yards to hurl the cherry and the spinners trundling in from five or six yards - unless you were Derek Underwood or Ajantha Mendis - to let go of the ball. But anyone who thinks bowling spin comes easy clearly doesn't understand cricket enough.

And it's not as if spinners aren't putting themselves at the risk of picking up injuries, either. The seam cutting against the inside of the forefinger and the middle finger triggers such pain and discomfort that oftentimes, it's hard to even grip the ball and well nigh impossible to release it with the desired revs. But such is their devotion to their craft that the finger spinners make light of such terrible exigencies, determined to hoodwink batters in the air and off the surface while being mindful of how much the odds are stacked against them in modern-day cricket.

If the lot of quality finger-spinners is anything but straightforward, think of the wrist-spinner. There is arguably no other type of bowling that asks such probing questions as that of a wristie. For starters, they need to be encouraged to keep at it because a bad delivery is never far away, because such is the very nature of that craft. Especially in one's formative years, it is very easy to get disheartened, and more so if encouragement isn't forthcoming from coaches, captains, parents and peers. But even when one establishes themselves at the highest level, the gremlins of self-doubt never disappear completely.

Shane Warne might have made leg-spin look glamorous and ridiculously easy with his larger-than-life persona and a supreme command over how the ball left his hand but hey, how many wrist-spinners have taken 700 Test wickets? Or even 700 wickets in first-class cricket? Warne was the striking exception, the genius touched by greatness long before he made an eminently forgettable Test debut in Sydney in January 1992 against India. Figures of one for 150 - his lone success was double-centurion Ravi Shastri - were hardly flattering, but Warne wasn't the only to show that it isn't how you start, but how you develop and finish, that matters the most.

Generous with inputs

Warne wasn't just a great bowler, he was also generous with his inputs and advice, with his learnings and wisdom. In international cricket, they talk of a fast bowlers' club, and a spinners' club. For a long time, the latter was populated by three of the most successful tweekers of all time - Warne, Sri Lankan giant Muttiah Muralitharan (Test cricket's highest wicket-taker with 800 scalps) and our own Anil Kumble, with the temperament of a fast bowler and the heart of a champion that often took the sheen away from his not inconsiderable skillset.

It was probably little less than providential that two of these three members contributed to a rookie left-arm wrist-spinner - the term Chinaman is frowned upon these days, apparently because it is politically incorrect - announcing himself on the world stage more than nine and a half years back. Kumble was India's head coach for only one year - more the Indian team's loss than the towering Bengalesean's - but that was time enough for him to bequeath to Indian cricket that great rarity in the history of the game, a left-arm wrist-spinner.

Through the first three of Australia's four Tests in India in early 2017, Kuldeep Yadav was steadfastly ignored by Virat Kohli. An unfortunate shoulder injury to the captain forced him to miss the decider in Dharamsala - the series was tied 1-1 - and Ajinkya Rahane, the stand-in skipper, heeded his coach's words and opted to throw the 22-year-old from Kanpur into the deep end.

Master's advice

His first bowl is what we tend to call a 'dream debut'. On a decidedly pacer-friendly day-one strip at the HPCA Stadium, he made Australia's batters dance to his tune. Kumble had facilitated a conversation



A bank that India can deep dive into in the Africas

Perhaps now, the turnaround is imminent. Only time will tell, but watching Kuldeep run rings around the West Indian batters in Thiruvananthapuram on Sunday in the first ODI, you couldn't help but wonder why successive team managements haven't invested more in this now mature, seasoned 31-year-old.

NIRMAL HARINDRAN

THE GIST

Kuldeep's career has, as has been well chronicled, not taken off along expected lines. omehow, he has been the most expendable of the spinners, ostensibly at the altar of batting depth

Kohli produced another one of his trademark centuries in a chase, seeing the team home by eight wickets with plenty to spare, and Gill dazzled with a pleasing hundred of his own, but there truly was only one candidate for the Player of the Match award

Kuldeep had single-handedly downscaled the West Indian total by at least 50 runs

The left-arm wrist spinner has found a way to spring back several times, and one can only hope that Sunday is a seminal moment in that it will lead to a sustained expression of tricks and sleight of hand



between Warne and Kuldeep before the match, and while English may not have been the latter's strongest suit at the time, he showed that language is hardly a barrier when it comes to cricket by putting the master's advice to great effect.

His first Test wicket was that of David Warner, with a flipper that Warne had talked about in detail. Then followed the sticks of Peter Handscomb, Glenn Maxwell - coming off a century in the previous game in Ranchi - and Nagpur as Kuldeep finished with four for 68 from 23 outstanding overs. A start had emerged, you told yourself, a star for whom the sky was the limit.

Kuldeep's career has, as has been well chronicled, not taken off along expected lines. Nine and a half years after that stirring debut,

he has only 19 Test caps. Somehow, he has been the most expendable of the spinners, ostensibly at the altar of batting depth. For a type of bowler who relies on confidence, trust, encouragement and backing, to be forced to look over his shoulder and wonder if he will get a second Test on the trot isn't the ideal base from which to perform, as former India leg-spinner Narendra Hirwani agreed during a conversation with this writer a couple of weeks.

Pigeonholed more as a limited-overs bowler - 122 ODIs and 54 T20Is for 198 and 95 scalps respectively - Kuldeep has plugged away manfully in the two shorter formats. He must be hurting immensely at not playing more Tests, even on home patch, and sometimes, that feeling of hurt and maybe not being wanted has manifested itself in scratchy, underwhelming performances that infuriate because one knows that Kuldeep is capable of much, much more.

Turning a corner?

Perhaps now, the turnaround is imminent. Or perhaps, even now, that could be a false dawn. Only time will tell, but watching Kuldeep run rings around the West Indian batters in Thiruvananthapuram on Sunday in the first ODI, you couldn't help but wonder why successive team managements haven't invested more in this now mature, seasoned 31-year-old.

Put in on an excellent batting the Caribbeans strip, seemed on course for a total in excess of 350 on the back of sterling opening stand of 135 between Justin Greaves and John Campbell in just 19.2 overs. Enter Kuldeep, so send them tumbling to 198 for five, including wickets in successive deliveries of Greaves and Jewel Andrew, who had no answer to a ripping wrong 'un that caught the splice of his bat and lobbed to Rohit Sharma at slip.

Kuldeep finished with four for 40, his best ODI figures since September 2023, when he took five for 25 against Pakistan in the Asia Cup in Colombo. Only thrice subsequently in the next 34 ODIs until Sunday did he manage a four-wicket haul, but there was something different about how the ball left his left hand in Thiruvananthapuram.

Flow and confidence

The pace was optimal, the control impeccable, the rhythm very, very evident. It certainly helped that he got a wicket early on because more than anyone else, Kuldeep

thrives on flow and confidence, and once he realised that he was hitting the areas that he was targeting, he appeared so dangerous as to threaten a wicket almost every delivery.

Kohli produced another one of his trademark centuries in a chase, seeing the team home by eight wickets with plenty to spare, and Shubman Gill dazzled with a pleasing hundred of his own, but there truly was only one candidate for the Player of the Match award.

Kuldeep had single-handedly downscaled the West Indian total by at least 50 runs and while there is no gainsaying what the outcome would have been even if Shai Hope's men had touched or crossed 350, the wrist-spinner pulled the chase down to little more than ordinary proportions with his mesmeric presence at the bowling crease.

Not the best of times

Across formats, Kuldeep hasn't had the best of times of late. He hasn't taken more than two wickets in a T20I innings for 12 months, while the last of his five five-fors in Test cricket came in October last year, also against West Indies. His last five bowls in the five-day game have brought him just four successes in 54.5 overs and he had a forgettable Galle Test last month, finishing with match figures of one for 103 from 25 overs as he was comprehensively shaded by finger-spinners Manav Suthar and Ravindra Jadeja.

Kuldeep has found himself at a crossroads so often in his nearly decade-long international career that he must experience a sense of déjà vu whenever he is pushed to a corner. He has found a way to spring back several times, and one can only hope that Sunday is a seminal moment in that it will lead to a sustained expression of tricks and sleight of hand.

Over the next week, in the next two ODIs, and in the five T20Is to follow, he will get further opportunities to build on this grand start to the home season. If he can snare a bagful of wickets, it will put him in an excellent state of mind as India head to New Zealand in three weeks' time for their first full tour there since January 2020.

Kuldeep is the kind of bowler who can make a decisive impact even on pitches that don't offer him much help, a bank India will hope to dip into at the 50-over World Cup in the Africas in 12 months' time.

For long, Kuldeep himself has been his worst enemy; that's something he and the think-tank must work assiduously to arrest as Indian cricket enters an exciting phase pregnant with glorious possibilities.

